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Review preview status

This is a review preview, not a finished grammar. It is assembled from first-pass publication-review slices and is controlled by `output/publication_review/whole_grammar_coverage_checkpoint_after_transitivity.md`, `output/publication_review/whole_grammar_coverage_checkpoint_after_reduplication.md`, `output/publication_review/whole_grammar_coverage_audit.md`, `docs/SKELETON_GRAMMAR.md`, `docs/grammar/GRAMMAR_SOURCE_INVENTORY.md`, and `PROGRESS.md`.

`output/publication_review/review_notes_transitivity.md` brought the transitivity packet to review-note maturity, and the post-transitivity checkpoint now treats the packet set as stable enough for a review preview assembled from actual slice prose. This document is not a new grammar slice, not a dictionary slice, and not a human-review packet. It is intended to help human review and direct editing, not to certify completion.

Many sections are deliberately narrow. Missing or blocked domains are marked explicitly. The PDF built from this assembly is a review preview PDF, not a final publication PDF.

PDF/build status

This preview is reproducible from committed sources with `python3 scripts/assemble_publication_review_preview.py`. The script writes `output/publication_review/assembled_grammar_review_preview.md`, generates `output/publication_review/assembled_grammar_review_preview.tex` through Pandoc plus `natbib`/BibTeX citation processing, and compiles `output/publication_review/assembled_grammar_review_preview.pdf` with XeLaTeX while routing publication-review example blocks through the shared analyzer and gb4e interlinear machinery.

The assembly reuses current repository conventions where practical: the repository bibliography in `literature/bibliography.bib`, XeLaTeX compilation and the Times New Roman / Helvetica font pair already used in `scripts/export_interlinear.py`, the shared Bible/analyzer helpers in `scripts/interlinear_latex.py`, and the same 0.75-inch page-margin convention for generated TeX output.

Abbreviations

Standard Leipzig Glossing Abbreviations

1	first person	IMP	imperative
2	second person	INCL	inclusive
3	third person	INS	instrumental
ABIL	abilitative	INTENS	intensive
ABL	ablative	IRR	irrealis
ALL	allative	ITER	iterative
APPL	applicative	LOC	locative
CAUS	causative	NEG	negative
COM	comitative	NMLZ	nominalizer
COMPL	completive	PFV	perfective
CONT	continuative	PL	plural
CVB	converb	POSS	possessive
DAT	dative	PROSP	prospective
DIMIN	diminutive	PROX	proximal
ERG	ergative	Q	question particle
EXCL	exclusive	RECIP	reciprocal
EXP	experiential	REFL	reflexive
GEN	genitive	REL	relativizer
HAB	habitual	RES	resultative
HORIZ	horizontal	SG	singular
IMM	immediate	TOP	topic

Tedim Chin-Specific Conventions

1SG→3	first singular acting on third person
2→1	second person acting on first person
3→1	third person acting on first person
AG	agent (nominalizer)
AUG	augmentative (big/great)
DIST	distal/anaphoric demonstrative
DOWN	downward directional
HAB.CONT	habitual continuative
I	verb form I (citation form)
II	verb form II (dependent form)
MORE	comparative (more X)
NEG.ABIL	negative abilitative (cannot)
PROX	proximal demonstrative
TOWARD	goal directional
UP	upward directional

Verb Forms: Tedim Chin verbs have two conjugation forms. I (Form I) is the citation/independent form; II (Form II) appears in dependent clauses and certain constructions.

Known narrow-slice limitations

- VP structure / suffix stacking: currently anchored by *bawlzoding*.
- derivation / valency: currently anchored by *-sak*.
- prefix/agreement: currently anchored by *kanei* / *kainn*.
- clause linkage: currently anchored by *ciangin*.
- nominalization: currently anchored by *-na* / *bawl-na*.

- NP structure / possession: currently anchored by *hih mite*, *mi khat*, *mi khempeuh*.
- noun domain: currently anchored by *gam* and *aksi / aksi-te*.
- reduplication: currently anchored by *mahmah / taktak*, with *peuhpeuh* secondary.
- transitivity: currently anchored by *sih / suak* versus *hawl / en*.

Major unresolved domains

- [MAJOR GAP: phonology/tone remains blocked or theory-heavy.]
- [MAJOR GAP: verb paradigms remain report-backed but not packet-shaped.]
- [MAJOR GAP: broader discourse remains partly surfaced and boundary-heavy.]
- [MAJOR GAP: analyzer-gap topics remain cross-cutting blockers.]

Second-pass expansions such as *-pih*, *ki-*, *hong-/kong-*, switch reference, relative clauses, transparent compounds, wider reduplication, and labile or ambitransitive transitivity remain outside this first-pass assembled review preview.

Phonology and tone

[MAJOR GAP: phonology/tone remains blocked or theory-heavy.]

The controlling checkpoints and audit still treat phonology/tone as blocked or theory-heavy, so no publication-review grammar slice is inlined here yet.

Deixis, pronouns, and nominal domain

Demonstratives / deixis

Source slice: output/publication_review/grammar_demonstratives_print_slice.md

Scope

This account offers a short treatment of Tedim demonstratives and deixis. It is intentionally narrow. It focuses on a small set of manually checked Bible examples and on the interaction between the core demonstratives *hih* and *tua*, their plural forms, and a few strong constructional extensions. It does not attempt a full treatment of copulas, sentence-final particles, directionals, or broad discourse structure.

Overview of the demonstrative system

The current Bible corpus and the literature agree on a compact demonstrative core: proximal *hih* and distal *tua* (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017). In Bible usage, however, *tua* is not merely a spatial “that”. It is also a strongly anaphoric and discourse-linking form, especially in narrative and temporal sequencing. The most economical description is therefore a system with *hih* as the core proximal demonstrative and *tua* as the core distal/anaphoric demonstrative.

The plural forms *hihte* and *tuате* behave transparently as DEM + *-te*, and the Bible also gives strong constructional material such as *hih bangin*, *tua bangin*, *tua ciangin*, and *tua ahih ciangin*. One caution remains explicit throughout this slice: Zam Ngaih Cing gives distal *huā*, while the Bible corpus overwhelmingly uses *tua* as the ordinary distal/anaphoric form (Cing, 2017). The relation is plausible, but it is not resolved here as a settled orthographic identity.

Core demonstratives: *hih* and *tua*

Hih is the clearest proximal form in the present corpus. It works both as an identificational demonstrative and as an adnominal determiner.

- (2.1) *Hih pèn Adam' suanlekhakte' laibu àhì hì.*
 PROX TOP ADAM.POSS genealogy-PL.POSS book be.3SG DECL
 'This is the book of the generations of Adam.' (Genesis 5:1)

Genesis 5:1 is especially useful because it shows *hih* as the unmarked proximal form in identificational prose. Genesis 9:12 *Hih pen ... thuciamna lim ahi hi* confirms the same pattern, while Exodus 32:9 *Hih mite ka mu zo hi* shows *hih* before a noun phrase in ordinary adnominal use.

Tua belongs to the same system, but its range in the Bible is broader. It clearly marks distal or previously activated referents, and it also extends naturally into anaphoric and discourse-linking uses.

- (2.2) *Pasian in, tuite' lai-zang-àh vàn kuum-pì òm hèn lá, túa vàn kuum-pì*
 God ERG water-PL.POSS middle-side-LOC sky bow-big exist JUSS take DIST sky bow-big
in tùi lè tùi kī-khen-sàk hèn cí hì.
 ERG water and water REFL-divide-CAUS JUSS say DECL
 'And God said, Let there be a firmament in the midst of the waters, and let it divide the waters from the waters.' (Genesis 1:6)

Genesis 1:6 is a clean adnominal example. Genesis 21:27 *tua mi nihte* is equally good for a more discourse-linked noun phrase. The important descriptive point is that the corpus keeps using *tua* where English may translate "that", "the same", or simply a contextually given referent.

Plural forms: *hihte* and *tuatè*

The plural demonstratives are straightforward. The Bible corpus strongly supports *hihte* and *tuatè* as transparent plural extensions of the singular forms.

- (2.3) *Israel in Josef' tapa-tè à mùh cìang-in àmàh in, hìh-tè kua àhì hiam*
 ISRAEL ERG JOSEF.POSS son-PL 3SG see.II then-ERG 3SG.PRO ERG HIHTE who be.3SG Q
à cí hì.
 3SG say DECL
 'And Israel beheld Joseph's sons, and said, Who are these?' (Genesis 48:8)

- (2.4) *Mual lian-tè tòngàh tùi om-tò láì à, túa-tè tòngàh pì sàwm-nìh*
 mountain big-PL on-LOC water be-over midst 3SG DIST-PL on-LOC grandmother ten-two
lè nìh thuk-in tuumcip hì.
 and two deep-INST water DECL
 'Fifteen cubits upward did the waters prevail; and the mountains were covered.' (Genesis 7:20)

Genesis 10:20 *Hihte pen ... Ham' suanlekhakte ahi hi* shows the proximal plural in topic-like prose, while Genesis 2:19 *mipa in tuatè bang a cí hiam* shows the distal plural as an ordinary pronoun. Nothing in the present corpus suggests that these need any more complex treatment than DEM + *-te*.

Adnominal and pronominal uses

The same forms serve both as adnominal modifiers and as independent pronouns. Adnominal use is easy to see in Exodus 32:9 *Hih mite*, Genesis 1:6 *tua van kuumpi*, and Genesis 21:27 *tua mi nihte*. Pronominal use is equally clear in Genesis 5:1 *Hih pen*, Genesis 48:8 *Hihte kua ahi hiam?*, and Genesis 2:19 *tuatè bang a cí hiam*.

The Bible also shows productive matter/topic phrases such as *hih thu* and *tua thu*. In Genesis 24:9 *hih thu tawh kisai-in* points to the present matter under discussion, while Genesis 6:6 *tua thu in ama lungsim dahsak hi* and Exodus 2:15 *Faro in tua thu a zak ciangin* show anaphoric reference to something just reported. These are important for the grammar chapter, even if they do not have to be first-round dictionary headwords.

Discourse and temporal deixis

This is where *tua* most clearly exceeds a merely spatial description. In Bible narrative, *tua* is a major discourse and temporal linker.

- (2.5) *Pasian in, khuavak òm hèn cí hì; túa ciang-in khuavak òm pah hì.*
God ERG light exist JUSS say DECL DIST then-ERG light exist do.so DECL
'And God said, Let there be light: and there was light.' (Genesis 1:3)

Tua ciangin works naturally as "then / at that time" in event sequencing. Genesis 5:5 repeats the same pattern in obituary-style narrative: *tua ciangin amah si hi*.

Tua ahih ciangin is even more explicitly a discourse bridge, linking a prior state or event to the next clause.

- (2.6) *Túa àhih ciang-in Topa Pasian in mipa ihmud sùak màhmàh sàk à,*
DIST be.3SG.REL then-ERG Lord God ERG man deep.sleep wither very CAUS 3SG
àmà ihmud kal-in à nak-gùh-tè khàt lá-in túa mún pèn sá-tak
3SG.POSS deep.sleep middle-CVB 3SG nose-bone-PL one take-ERG DIST place TOP flesh-piece
tàwh à dimsak hì.
COM 3SG fill DECL
'And the LORD God caused a deep sleep to fall upon Adam, and he slept: and he took one of his ribs, and closed up the flesh instead thereof.' (Genesis 2:21)

Genesis 1:21 and Genesis 2:19 confirm that *tua ahih ciangin* is one of the strongest discourse-transition frames in the present corpus. It is better understood as a fixed demonstrative-temporal construction than as a purely compositional spatial phrase.

Manner constructions with *bangin*

The Bible also gives strong manner and discourse constructions built from the demonstratives plus *bangin*.

- (2.7) *àmaute hih-in, nòtè in kà topa Esau kiang-àh hih bàng-in nà cí dīng*
3PL.PRO teach-CVB 2PL.PRO ERG 1SG lord ESAU beside-LOC PROX like-ERG 2SG say IRR
ùh hì: Nà nàsèm-pà Jakob in, laban' kiang-àh peem-tà-in tù
2/3PL DECL 2SG servant-male JAKOB ERG LABAN.POSS beside-LOC widow.son-PFV-ERG now
ciang dòng kà òm hì.
then until 1SG exist DECL
'And he commanded them, saying, Thus shall ye speak unto my lord Esau; Thy servant Jacob saith thus, I have sojourned with Laban, and stayed there until now.' (Genesis 32:4)
- (2.8) *Topa in túa bàng-in Egypt mite' khutsung pàn-in túa nì-in Israel-té*
Lord ERG DIST like-ERG EGYPT person-PL.POSS palm ABL-ERG DIST day-ERG ISRAEL-TE
honkhia à, tùi-pì gei-àh Egypt mì à sí-tè, Israel mì-tè in mú
deliver 3SG water-big edge-LOC EGYPT person 3SG die-PL ISRAEL person-PL ERG see.I
ùh hì.
2/3PL DECL
'Thus the LORD saved Israel that day out of the hand of the Egyptians; and Israel saw the Egyptians dead upon the sea shore.' (Exodus 14:30)

Hih bangin is especially good for direct instruction or quoted manner, as also seen in Genesis 42:18 *hih bangin gamta un*. *Tua bangin* often resumes or summarizes an already described event, as in Genesis 50:21 *Amah in tua bangin ... amaute a hehnem hi*. These patterns belong naturally in a demonstratives slice because the deictic base still contributes to how the construction organizes discourse.

Deferred forms: *hi* and *hih ciangin*

Hi should be deferred. Exact-token *hi* is far too entangled with copular, auxiliary, and sentence-final material to serve as a safe demonstrative headword in this packet. Genesis 48:18 *Hi lo hi, pa aw; hih pen a suak masa ahi hi* shows how quickly the shorter form is absorbed into other clause types. The right place for *hi* is later work on copula or sentence-final particles, not this first demonstratives packet.

Hih ciangin should also be deferred. The current dossier showed that many apparent hits involve verbal *hih* “do/be thus” rather than demonstrative *hih*. Genesis 18:10, the old generated-report example, does not contain exact demonstrative *hih ciangin*. For the present slice, *tua ciangin* is strong enough to represent the temporal side of the system on its own.

Editorial summary

The current evidence supports a compact but stable demonstrative system. *Hih* is the core proximal demonstrative. *Tua* is the core distal/anaphoric demonstrative and should not be reduced to a merely spatial “that”. *Hih* and *tuate* are transparent plural forms, and the constructional extensions *hih bangin*, *tua bangin*, *tua ciangin*, and *tua ahih ciangin* are all well supported by manually checked Bible examples.

Just as important, the chapter has to preserve its cautions. *Hi* is not yet safe as a demonstrative headword, *hih ciangin* is not yet a stable temporal counterpart to *tua ciangin*, and the relation between Bible *tua* and the literature’s *huā* is plausible but unresolved. With those limits kept explicit, demonstratives and deixis make a good narrow chapter for the next Tedim packet.

Pronouns / clusivity

Source slice: `output/publication_review/grammar_pronouns_print_slice.md`

Scope

This account presents a short print-facing chapter on Tedim personal pronouns and closely related pronominal marking. It covers independent personal pronouns, first-person plural forms and clusivity, possessive prefixes, emphatic forms in *-mah*, reflexive and reciprocal marking with *ki-*, and a cautious first treatment of *hong-* and *kong-*. It does not attempt a full account of demonstratives, interrogatives, quantifiers, TAM, or the wider verbal agreement system.

Personal pronouns

Earlier descriptions agree on a basic personal-pronoun system with distinct first, second, and third persons and with plural forms for at least the first and second persons (Henderson, 1965, 32-33; Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.1). Henderson explicitly lists *kei*, *nang*, *amah*, *ei/eite*, *ko/kote*, and *no/note*, while Zam Ngaih Cing confirms the broader person-and-number system and the absence of gender in the third person (Henderson, 1965, 32; Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.1). For print purposes, the following paradigm is stable enough to use:

Person	Singular	Plural
1	<i>kei</i>	<i>eite, kote</i>
2	<i>nang</i>	<i>note</i>
3	<i>amah</i>	<i>amaute</i>

- (2.9) *Mipa in à zi’ mīn pèn Eve, cí hì. Bàng hàng hiam cih lèh àmah*
man ERG 3SG wife.POSS name TOP EVE say DECL like reason Q say.NOM and 3SG.PRO
pèn mì-hìng khèmpeuh’ nù àhì hì.
TOP person-kind all.POSS female be.3SG DECL

’And Adam called his wife’s name Eve; because she was the mother of all living.’ (Genesis 3:20)

- (2.10) *Ēn ùn, nòtè lè nòtè' khìt à nà suanlekhak-tè ùh lè,*
 look IMP.PL 2PL.PRO and 2PL.PRO.POSS SEQ 3SG 2SG genealogy-PL 2/3PL and
 'And I, behold, I establish my covenant with you, and with your seed after you;' (Genesis 9:9)

These examples are ordinary independent pronouns rather than bound agreement markers. *amah* functions as a free third-person form, while *note* shows the equally straightforward second-person plural. The printed chapter can therefore begin from free pronouns and only then move to the more tightly bound prefixal system.

First-person plural forms and clusivity

The main editorial problem in this slice is not whether Tedim has clusivity, but how far the current evidence supports global labels for the two first-person plural series. Henderson clearly distinguishes *ei/eite* from *ko/kote* through pronominal-concord prefixes, pairing the former with *i-* and the latter with *ka-* (Henderson, 1965, 32-33). Zam Ngaih Cing likewise treats clusivity as a real feature of Tedim person marking, even though her presentation of the plural forms is not identical in surface detail (Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.1; Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.2). The separate clusivity dossier for this slice shows that sampled Bible dialogue contexts strongly support *ko/kote* as exclusive, but that *ei/eite* has both clear inclusive uses and less straightforward uses in the current Bible evidence. Comparative Sukte is useful here mainly as a contrast, since Singh does not describe the same inclusive/exclusive opposition for Sukte (Singh, 2018, sec. 4.6.1).

- (2.11) *Túa ciang-in Abram in Lot' kiang-àh, nàng lè kèi' kī-kal,*
 DIST then-ERG ABRAM ERG LOT.POSS beside-LOC 2SG.PRO and NEG.EMPH.POSS REFL-middle
nàng' gán-cing-tè lè kèi' gán-cing-te' kī-kal-àh
 2SG.PRO.POSS cattle-care-PL and NEG.EMPH.POSS cattle-care-PL.POSS REFL-middle-LOC
kī-tot-ná òm-sàk kèi nì. Bàng hàng hiam cih lèh eite beh khàt
 REFL-cut-NMLZ exist-CAUS NEG day like reason Q say.NOM and 1PL.PRO tribe one
ì-hí hì''
 1PL.INCL-be DECL
 'And Abram said unto Lot, Let there be no strife, I pray thee, between me and thee, and between my herdmen and thy herdmen; for we be brethren.' (Genesis 13:8)

- (2.12) *Kòtè tàwh kī-ten-ná hòng bāwl ùn. Nà tanu-tè ùh kòtè'*
 1PL.PRO COM REFL-marry-NMLZ 3→1 make IMP.PL 2SG daughter-PL 2/3PL 1PL.PRO.POSS
tùngàh hòng píá ùn-lá, no à dīng-in kà tanu-tè ùh lá ùn.
 on-LOC 3→1 give PL.IMP-and young 3SG IRR-ERG 1SG daughter-PL 2/3PL take IMP.PL
 'And make ye marriages with us, and give your daughters unto us, and take our daughters unto you.' (Genesis 34:9)

Genesis 13:8 shows a genuinely inclusive use of *eite*, since Abram explicitly includes Lot in the relevant group. It does not prove that every *eite* token is inclusive. Genesis 34:9, by contrast, is a strong diagnostic for exclusive *kote*, since Hamor addresses Jacob's family from a distinct in-group. The present slice therefore treats *kote* as exclusive and leaves the exact global status of *eite* under review.¹

Possessive prefixes

The same person-marking forms that appear in pronominal concord also appear before nouns as possessive prefixes. Henderson treats *ka-*, *na-*, *a-*, and *i-* primarily as pronominal concord prefixes, while Zam Ngaih Cing foregrounds their possessive use in noun phrases (Henderson, 1965, 32-33; Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.2; Cing, 2017, sec. 3.3.4.1.1). For a printed grammar, the safest description is that the forms are shared across possessive and agreement environments, but are easiest to present first in their nominal use.

¹The earlier report-level reversal *kote* inclusive versus *eite* exclusive has now been removed. The safer editorial position is narrower: *ko/kote* can already be treated as exclusive, but *ei/eite* still shows mixed Bible-corpus behavior and should remain under review rather than receiving a single global label.

- (2.13) *Kua' tá-nù nà hì hiam, hòng gēn ìn. Nà pa' inn-àh*
 who.POSS child-female 2SG DECL Q 3→1 speak ERG 2SG male.POSS house-LOC
kòtè' giah nàdìng à áwng dīng hiam? à cí hì.
 1PL.PRO.POSS camp PURP 3SG open IRR Q 3SG say DECL
 'Whose daughter art thou? tell me, I pray thee: is there room in thy father's house for us to lodge in?'
 (Genesis 24:23)

- (2.14) *Mipa ìn à zì' mīn pèn Eve, cí hì.*
 man ERG 3SG wife.POSS name TOP EVE say DECL
 'And the man called his wife's name Eve.' (Genesis 3:20)

The same pattern is visible in *ka pa' inn* 'my father's house' and in the *i-* prefix that Henderson associates with the *ei/eite* series (Henderson, 1965, 32-33). Singh's Sakte comparison is also helpful here, since it shows cognate person-marking prefixes in possessive use even though the wider systems are not identical (Singh, 2018, sec. 4.5.4). Plural verbal markers such as *-uh* belong to the later agreement chapter rather than to the pronoun inventory itself.

Emphatic pronouns in *-mah*

Emphatic pronouns are formed by adding *-mah* to a personal-pronoun base (Henderson, 1965, 32; Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.6). In print, it is best to treat these forms neither as an unrelated lexical series nor as mere stylistic variants, but as a productive emphatic pattern built on the ordinary pronoun paradigm.

- (2.15) *Kain ìn Topa' tòngàh, Kèimah gīm hòng kī-piāk-ná, kà thùak zàwh*
 KAIN ERG Lord.POSS on-LOC 1SG.PRO suffering 3→1 REFL-give.to-NMLZ 1SG suffer able
dīng hì lò hì.
 IRR DECL NEG DECL
 'And Cain said unto the LORD, My punishment is greater than I can bear.' (Genesis 4:13)

- (2.16) *Abimelek ìn, Ēn ìn, kà léi-tāng, nà mái-àh ōm hì. Nangmah ìn hòih nà*
 ABIMELEK ERG look ERG 1SG land-earth 2SG face-LOC exist DECL 2SG.PRO ERG good 2SG
sàk-ná mún-àh tēng ìn, à cí hì.
 cause-NMLZ place-LOC remain ERG 3SG say DECL
 'And Abimelech said, Behold, my land is before thee: dwell where it pleaseth thee.' (Genesis 20:15)

The same element also appears in negative-indefinite forms such as *kuamah* 'no one' and *bangmah* 'nothing' (Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.7). Those items belong more naturally to a later section on indefinites and interrogative-based forms, but the connection should already be noted here.

Reflexive and reciprocal marking with *kī-*

Zam Ngaih Cing describes reflexive pronouns as repeated pronouns linked by *leh* (Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.5). The biblical corpus nevertheless makes it clear that a print grammar also needs to acknowledge verbal *kī-*, since many reader-facing examples of reflexive or reciprocal meaning are expressed through *kī-* forms rather than through a free reflexive pronoun alone.

- (2.17) *Túa thù hàng-ìn pasal ìn à nù lè à pà nusia-ìn à zì*
 DIST word because-ERG husband ERG 3SG female and 3SG father abandon-ERG 3SG wife
tàwh kī-gawm à, àmau tegel pum khàt à bàng ùh hì.
 COM REFL-seize 3SG 3PL.PRO both body one 3SG like 2/3PL DECL
 'Therefore shall a man leave his father and his mother, and shall cleave unto his wife: and they shall be one flesh.' (Genesis 2:24)

For print purposes, *ki-* can already be described as a productive reflexive or reciprocal verbal prefix. The remaining caution is lexical rather than structural: some surface *ki-* forms are lexicalized stems, so not every *ki-* word should be taken automatically as transparent reflexive morphology.

Pronominal prefixes and inverse/directional marking

Henderson’s discussion of pronominal concord is still the best starting point for the bound prefix system. She pairs *kei* with *ka-*, *nang* with *na-*, the *ei/eite* series with *i-*, the *ko/kote* series with *ka-*, *no/note* with *na-*, and all other nominals with *a-* (Henderson, 1965, 32-33). Zam Ngaih Cing’s discussion of nominal prefixes confirms the same basic person-marking inventory in noun phrases (Cing, 2017, sec. 3.3.4.1.1). A printed chapter on pronouns does not need the whole verbal paradigm yet, but it does need to note that the independent pronouns belong to a wider system of bound person marking.

The harder question concerns *hong-* and *kong-*. The literature treats them as participant-oriented preverbal prefixes with directional or inverse-like behavior, and Otsuka’s causative discussion shows that first- and second-person objects are structurally important to their distribution (Cing, 2017, sec. 5.8.1.3; Otsuka, 2009). The current corpus outputs, however, do not yet yield a stable automatic example set for *hong-*, so the present slice uses only narrow, manually checked illustrations.²

- (2.18) *Àmàh ìn à sàng-ná pàn-ìn à khùt tàwǎ zā-mīn kèi hòng lá à,*
 3SG.PRO ERG 3SG high-NMLZ ABL-ERG 3SG hand COM hundred-thousand NEG 3→1 take 3SG
tùì thuk-pì pàn-ìn kèimàh hòng kà-ì-khà hì.
 water deep-big ABL-ERG 1SG.PRO 3→1 1SG-go-exit DECL
 ‘He sent from above, he took me, He drew me out of many waters.’ (Psalms 18:16)

- (2.19) *Faro ìn Josef’ kiang-àh, Egypt gàm khèmpèuh à ùk dīng-ìn nàng kòng*
 FARO ERG JOSEF.POSS beside-LOC EGYPT land all 3SG rule IRR-ERG 2SG.PRO 1SG→3
kòih khin-zò hì, à cí hì.
 put COMPL-COMPL DECL 3SG say DECL
 ‘And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, See, I have set thee over all the land of Egypt.’ (Genesis 41:41)

These examples are enough to justify a cautious print description: *hong-* and *kong-* belong with person-sensitive preverbal marking, but the exact boundary between inverse, venitive, benefactive, and wider directional readings still needs fuller chapter-level review. They should therefore appear in the dictionary slice and grammar prose, but under an explicitly provisional analysis rather than as a closed paradigm.

Editorial summary

This slice now supports a real draft chapter on pronouns and pronominal marking. Independent pronouns, emphatic forms in *-mah*, and possessive prefixes are straightforward enough for print. *ki-* is also clear enough to present as reflexive or reciprocal verbal marking, provided lexicalized forms remain a review checkpoint. The main unresolved issue is not the existence of clusivity or of *hong-/kong-*, but how far the current report layer can be trusted to label those patterns automatically without closer editorial control.

References

NP structure / possession

Source slice: *output/publication_review/grammar_np_possession_print_slice.md*

²The present editorial problem is not whether these forms exist, but how narrowly they should be defined in a first print chapter. The current wording stays close to cases that can be read directly from the verse context without relying on a fully solved backend analysis.

Editorial scope

This is the first narrow NP structure / possession grammar slice. It is controlled by `output/publication_review/candidate` and `output/publication_review/dossier_np_possession_scope.md`. Supporting/background evidence comes from `docs/grammar/reports/03-noun-06-np-structure.md`, `docs/grammar/reports/04-np-07-pos`, `docs/grammar/lit-reviews/04-np-07-possession-lit.md`, and `docs/grammar/morphemes/01-prefixes.md`.

This is not a full noun-phrase chapter, not a full possession chapter, not a full prefix/agreement chapter, and not a full case or relator chapter. It also stays narrow against `output/publication_review/review_notes_prefix_agreement`, `output/publication_review/review_notes_pronouns.md`, `output/publication_review/review_notes_case_`, `output/publication_review/review_notes_relators_postpositions.md`, `output/publication_review/review` and `tests/test_prefix_agr_poss.py`.

The present slice therefore covers only the first safe NP-ordering claim. No dictionary slice exists yet for NP structure / possession, because this packet is still establishing a controlled structural/syntactic claim rather than a lexical layer. The packet now properly proceeds through NP structure / possession review notes rather than a dictionary slice.

Basic NP ordering

The safest current claim in the packet is a small NP-ordering observation rather than a possession claim.

hih mite is the demonstrative-before-noun anchor. The controlled segmentation is *hih mi-te*, and the controlled gloss is *PROX person-PL*.

mi khat is the head-noun plus numeral anchor. The controlled gloss is *person one*.

mi khempueh is the head-noun plus quantifier anchor. The controlled segmentation is *mi khem-peuh*, and the controlled gloss is *person all*.

Taken together, these rows support a conservative NP-ordering statement: demonstratives can precede the head noun, while numerals and quantifier-like modifiers can follow the head noun. That is enough for a first print-facing claim, but it is not yet a full theory of all NP modifiers, adjectival ordering, recursive noun-phrase structure, or case closure.

Why possession is not yet the first slice

Possession and possessor-possession structure are also visible in the candidate layer through *ka pa*, *Topa' inn*, and *a pa' inn*.

Those rows stay outside the first print-facing claim because they still interact with prefix/agreement routing, pronouns, apostrophe or genitive analysis, and broader possessor-possession theory. *ka pa* is the safest possession row if a later possession sub-scope is chosen, but it is still more boundary-heavy than the three clean NP-order anchors.

Boundary material

The rest of the NP structure / possession packet stays outside the first grammar slice because each row is still dominated by another unresolved boundary.

ka pa, *Topa' inn*, and *a pa' inn* stay outside because possession and possessor-possession structure still interact with prefix/agreement routing, pronouns, apostrophe or genitive analysis, and broader possession theory.

Topa' tungah stays outside because possessive NP plus relator or case material remains shared with `review_notes_case_marking.md` and `review_notes_relators_postpositions.md`.

ka suahna leitang stays outside because nominalized noun-headed material remains shared with `review_notes_nominaliza`

isolated *a*, *ka*, or *na* prefix surfaces stay outside because they are analyzer-noisy away from a controlled nominal host.

Pronoun-led possessor rows such as *amah a pa* stay outside because they still sit between NP structure, possession, and the completed pronoun packet.

Tone-marked or literature-only genitive claims such as *-á* stay outside because they are not yet tied tightly enough to corpus-backed first-slice anchors.

report-only counts stay outside because attestation alone does not make a row safe for the first print-facing claim.

Any broad recursive possession chapter claim stays outside because this packet is not yet ready to generalize from one safe NP-ordering slice to the whole noun-domain architecture.

Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest NP structure / possession claim is that Tedim has candidate-controlled evidence for basic NP ordering: demonstratives can precede the noun, while numerals and quantifier-like modifiers can follow the noun. Possession and possessor-possessed structures remain candidate-layer or boundary material.

That claim is deliberately smaller than a full noun-phrase chapter, smaller than a full possession chapter, smaller than a full prefix/agreement chapter, and smaller than a full case or relator chapter.

Recommended next step

This packet now properly proceeds through NP structure / possession review notes rather than a dictionary slice, because this packet is structural/syntactic rather than lexical.

If later work returns to possession after review notes, it should be a separate narrow possession sub-scope led by *ka pa*, not a broad possession chapter.

Noun domain

Source slice: output/publication_review/grammar_noun_domain_print_slice.md

Editorial scope

This is the first narrow noun-domain grammar slice. It is controlled by `output/publication_review/candidates_noun_` and `output/publication_review/dossier_noun_domain_scope.md`. Supporting/background evidence comes from `docs/grammar/reports/03-noun-01-simple.md`, `docs/grammar/reports/03-noun-02-compounds.md`, `docs/grammar/reports/03-noun-03-proper.md`, `docs/grammar/compound_transparency_audit.md`, and `docs/grammar/opaque_lexemes.md`.

This is not a full noun chapter, not a compound-noun chapter, not a proper-noun chapter, and not a dictionary slice. It also stays narrow against `output/publication_review/review_notes_np_possession.md`, `output/publication_review/review_notes_nominalization.md`, `output/publication_review/review_notes_output/publication_review/review_notes_case_marking.md`, and `output/publication_review/review_note`

The present slice therefore covers only the first safe simple-noun-stem claim. No dictionary slice exists for the noun domain, because this packet is still establishing a grammar-facing noun-domain foundation rather than a lexical layer.

Simple noun stems

gam is the main simple free noun stem anchor.

The controlled report-backed forms are *gam*, *gam-te*, *gam-'*, *gam-in*, *gam-ah*, and *gam-te-ah*.

Taken together, these forms show a free noun stem that can host ordinary plural and case-like marking. That is enough for a first print-facing claim, but it is not a full noun inflection chapter, not a full case chapter, and not a full noun chapter.

aksi / *aksi-te* is the supporting plural row. It shows ordinary plural marking on a second simple noun without broadening the slice into a larger noun-domain inventory.

Why compounds are not yet the first slice

minam and *thugen* are the candidate-layer transparent compounds in the current packet.

They stay outside the first print-facing claim because compounds still require transparency and lexicalization decisions before they can safely lead grammar prose.

singnai and *sanggam* are the main boundary rows here. *sanggam* stays outside because it is opaque or lexicalized, while *singnai* stays outside because it is a transparency-problem row rather than a clean transparent-compound anchor.

Why proper nouns are not yet the first slice

Abraham is the clean proper-noun candidate, and *Topa* is title-like boundary material.

Proper nouns stay outside the first print-facing claim because they are more lexical-inventory-like than the simple noun anchors, and *Topa* also remains entangled with noun-domain and NP-possession boundary questions.

Boundary material

minam and *thugen* stay outside the first grammar slice because transparent compounds still require lexicalization and transparency decisions before they can lead noun-domain grammar prose.

singnai and *lamethuai* stay outside because they remain transparency-problem rows rather than first-slice anchors.

sanggam stays outside because it is opaque or lexicalized rather than a safe transparent-compound example.

kholhna stays outside because it is nominalization-boundary material rather than a clean simple noun stem.

Abraham and *Topa* stay outside because proper nouns remain more lexical-inventory-like than the simple noun anchors, while *Topa* is also title-like boundary material.

Topa 'inn or broader possessor syntax stay outside because they belong with NP structure / possession rather than the first noun-domain slice.

Pronoun-led possessors or person-head material stay outside because they still sit between noun-domain work, pronouns, and NP structure.

relator/postposition or case-dominated noun rows stay outside because their main value belongs with `review_notes_relators_postpositions.md` and `review_notes_case_marking.md`.

analyzer-noisy, report-only, or count-only noun-domain claims stay outside because they do not yet produce safe first-slice anchors.

Any broad noun chapter claim stays outside because this packet is not yet ready to generalize from one safe simple-noun-stem slice to the whole noun domain.

Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest noun-domain claim is that Tedim has candidate-controlled evidence for simple free noun stems that can host ordinary plural and case-like marking, with *gam* as the main anchor and *aksi* / *aksi-te* as supporting plural evidence. Compound nouns and proper nouns remain candidate-layer or boundary material.

That claim is deliberately smaller than a full noun chapter, smaller than a compound-noun chapter, smaller than a proper-noun chapter, and smaller than a dictionary slice.

Recommended next step

This grammar slice is now paired with `output/publication_review/review_notes_noun_domain.md`, so the packet is ready for human review at its current simple-noun-stem slice maturity level.

If more noun-domain work is chosen after review notes, the next sub-scope should be transparent compounds led by *minam* and *thugen*, not opaque compounds or proper nouns.

Case marking

Source slice: `output/publication_review/grammar_case_marking_print_slice.md`

Scope

This review slice presents a short draft chapter on nominal case marking and closely related postpositional constructions in Tedim Chin. It is intended as an editorial model for later sections of the grammar, not as a full treatment of nominal morphology. The discussion concentrates on ergative *-in*, locative *-ah*, ablative and source forms *-pan* and *-panin*, and comitative *-tawh*. A final section notes the role of relator nouns, since the clearest spatial examples regularly involve stems such as *lak*, *sung*, *kiang*, and *laizang*.

The present print-facing examples are controlled by `candidates_case_marking.tsv` and interpreted in `dossier_case_marking.md`. This keeps the slice narrow: the packet now prints candidate-backed anchors and explicit caveats rather than broadening into a new full chapter or a broad automatic case-marker survey.

Case marking in outline

Earlier descriptions agree that Tedim marks nominal relations after the noun phrase, but they differ in how they analyze those forms. Henderson describes them structurally as phrase-final or post-nominal particles rather than as a semantic case system (Henderson, 1965, 59; Henderson, 1965, 104). Zam Ngaih Cing, by contrast, offers a seven-case analysis with explicit ergative, locative, ablative, and comitative categories (Cing, 2017, sec. 3.3.3.3). Comparative Sukté evidence points in the same direction for several core markers, even though Singh labels the cognate *-in* as nominative rather than ergative (Singh, 2018, sec. 4.5.1).

For a printed grammar, the most useful generalization is therefore twofold. First, the language is well described by a case-marking analysis in the modern sense. Second, the most natural corpus examples often combine case markers with relational nominal stems, so a final chapter should not force an artificial boundary between “case suffixes” and “spatial nouns”.

Ergative *-in*

The ergative marker *-in* marks the transitive subject in Tedim Chin (Cing, 2017, sec. 3.3.3.3.1). Henderson does not use the label *ergative*, but her treatment of phrase-final nominal particles is compatible with the later analysis (Henderson, 1965, 59). Otsuka likewise assumes ergative *-in* in discussing causers in causative constructions (Otsuka, 2009). Comparative Sukté retains a cognate *-in* marker, though Singh describes it as nominative (Singh, 2018, sec. 4.5.1).

In this slice, Genesis 4:3 remains the accepted print anchor because `candidates_case_marking.tsv` and `dossier_case_marking.md` both treat *Kain in* as the cleanest candidate-backed ergative window. Raw *-in* extraction is unsafe: rows such as *ciangin* are conjunctive or other non-case material, so they must not be promoted as ergative case examples.

- (2.20) *Túa hùn sùng-in Kain in léi pà-ná piang gah piak-ná Topa'*
DIST time inside-ERG KAIN ERG buy father-NMLZ be.born branch give.to-NMLZ Lord.POSS
tùngàh pái-pìh à,
on-LOC go-APPL 3SG

'And in process of time it came to pass, that Cain brought of the fruit of the ground an offering unto the LORD.' (Genesis 4:3)

This example is sufficient for a draft chapter because it shows the essential pattern without relying on doubtful segmentation. The agent phrase *Kain in* is simple, animate, and immediately followed by a clearly transitive predicate. At the same time, the section remains cautious: one accepted candidate-backed example is enough to print the analysis, but additional *-in* rows should still be filtered against ambiguity controls such as *ciangin* before they are treated as nominal case evidence.

Locative *-ah*

The locative *-ah* marks location (Cing, 2017, sec. 3.3.3.3.3). Henderson already treats *-ah* as a locative post-nominal particle and discusses its phonological behavior in locative nominal figures (Henderson, 1965, 54-56). The current candidate layer, however, distinguishes plain noun-plus-locative evidence such as *khua-ah* from relator-noun-plus-case constructions such as *laizangah*, *vantungah*, *kiangah*, *sungah*, and *tungah*. The printed description should therefore be slightly richer than a simple gloss “at/in”, while still keeping those two subtypes distinct.

- (2.21) *Pasian in, tuite’ lai-zang-àh vùn kuum-pì òm hèn lá, túa vùn kuum-pì*
 God ERG water-PL.POSS middle-side-LOC sky bow-big exist JUSS take DIST sky bow-big
in tùì lè tùì kī-khen-sàk hèn cí hì.
 ERG water and water REFL-divide-CAUS JUSS say DECL
 ‘And God said, Let there be a firmament in the midst of the waters, and let it divide the waters from the waters.’ (Genesis 1:6)

- (2.22) *léi-tùng khua à vak-sàk dīng-in vantung-àh khuavak hì ùh hèn cí hì.*
 land-on town 3SG shine-CAUS IRR-ERG heaven-LOC light DECL 2/3PL JUSS say DECL
 ‘and let them be for lights in the firmament of the heaven to give light upon the earth’ (Genesis 1:15)

The first example shows especially clearly that *-ah* often completes a larger relational expression rather than attaching only to a simple lexical noun. The noun *laizang* contributes the spatial geometry ‘middle, interior region’, and *-ah* marks that whole phrase as locative. The second printed example is still best treated in the same relator-noun-plus-case domain, even if *vantung* looks less obviously relational than *laizang*. The plain noun-plus-locative control in the candidate layer is *khua-ah*, not one of these relator rows.

The analyzer export also needs to be read cautiously here. Some locative and relator rows surface with *pos_span=FUNC*, even though the grammar still treats the base as nominal or relational. That export label is useful metadata, but it is not decisive enough to collapse noun-like and relator-like rows into a single undifferentiated suffix list.

Directional/allative *-a*

Directional or allative *-a* remains deferred in the current packet. The candidate layer keeps *-a* separate from *-ah*, and the dossier is explicit that the present export does not yet distinguish directional *-a* cleanly from pronominal or other functional *a* tokens. For that reason, the current slice does **not** collapse *-a* into *-ah*, and it does not yet print a dedicated *-a* example.

Source marking: *-pan* and *-panin*

Zam Ngaih Cing describes *-pan* as the ablative marker indicating source or point of departure (Cing, 2017, sec. 3.3.3.3.5). Comparative Sukte has a cognate *-pan*, which strengthens the historical plausibility of the analysis (Singh, 2018). Henderson does not present an ablative category in the modern sense, but the source-marking behavior is nevertheless compatible with her structural account of post-nominal particles (Henderson, 1965, 104).

- (2.23) *Túa àhìh mán-in híh thù-khàm-te lak-pàn à néu-pèn-tè khàt bèk*
 DIST be.3SG.REL reason-ERG PROX law-PL midst-ABL 3SG small-most-PL one only
nà-ngawn zúi-khá lò-in, midang-tè in zòng à zùih lòh nàdìngin
 2SG-own follow-go NEG-ERG other.person-PL ERG also 3SG follow-NOM NEG-NOM PURP.ERG

à gēn mì-tè pèn vàn-tùng kī-ukna sùng-àh mì néu-pèn hì dīng
 3SG speak person-PL TOP sky-on REFL-rule.NMLZ inside-LOC person small-TOP DECL IRR
 ùh hì.
 2/3PL DECL

'Whosoever therefore shall break one of these least commandments, and shall teach men so, he shall be called the least in the kingdom of heaven.' (Matthew 5:19)

This example is worth keeping because it shows a natural source construction built on a relator noun. The source relation is real, but it is not expressed through a bare noun alone: *lak* 'among, in the midst of' combines with *-pan* to yield a source phrase meaning 'from among'. The current candidate layer therefore treats *lakpan* as source marking on a relator noun, not merely as a bare suffix example.

The related form *-panin* is common in the corpus and clearly belongs to the same source-marking domain, especially after relator nouns and other spatial expressions. What remains uncertain is not its source meaning, but its exact structural status in every occurrence. Some examples look like straightforward source phrases, while others behave more like extended or tightly fused source-marking expressions.

- (2.24) *Topa in Abram kiang-àh, nà gàm, nà beh, lè nà pa' inn pàn-in*
 Lord ERG ABRAM beside-LOC 2SG land 2SG tribe and 2SG male.POSS house ABL-ERG
nàng kòng làh dīng gàm-àh pái in
 2SG.PRO 1SG→3 lamp IRR land-LOC go ERG

'Now the LORD had said unto Abram, Get thee out of thy country, and from thy kindred, and from thy father's house.' (Genesis 12:1)

For that reason, a printed grammar can already gloss *-panin* as a source form related to *-pan*, but should avoid a stronger compositional claim until the full range of corpus contexts has been reviewed more closely. The analyzer segmentation *pan-in* is useful evidence for the packet, but it is not by itself a final structural analysis.

Comitative *-tawh*

The comitative *-tawh* is described in the literature as the marker of accompaniment (Cing, 2017, sec. 3.3.3.3.6). Henderson also lists *tawh* among the post-nominal particles (Henderson, 1965, 104). In the biblical corpus, however, the most accessible examples are semantically broader than simple human accompaniment. A printed chapter should therefore distinguish the core comitative use from its material and instrumental extensions rather than treating all examples as equivalent.³

- (2.25) *Tangvalte' nèk-sá-tè lè kèi tàwh hòng kúan mite' tàn̄h dīng-tè*
 youth-PL.POSS eat.II-flesh-PL and 1SG.PRO COM 3→1 family person-PL.POSS spread stand-PL
lobuang bangmah kà lá kèi dīng hì.
 disturb nothing 1SG take NEG IRR DECL

'save only that which the young men have eaten, and the portion of the men which went with me' (Genesis 14:24)

- (2.26) *Topa Pasian in léi-lak pà-ná leivui tàwh mì-hìng bāwl à, à nak sùng-àh*
 Lord God ERG dust father-NMLZ dust COM person-kind make 3SG 3SG nose inside-LOC
nuntak-ná hu sàng sùk hì.
 live-NMLZ breath high collapse DECL

'And the LORD God formed man of the dust of the ground, and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life.' (Genesis 2:7)

³The currently available biblical examples for *-tawh* are semantically good enough for review, but they do not all illustrate the most prototypical accompaniment reading. That is why the present slice pairs one accompaniment example with one extension example rather than treating Genesis 2:7 or Genesis 2:21 as if they were ordinary companion phrases.

Genesis 14:24 illustrates the core accompaniment use well enough for print: *kei tawh* marks the men as companions who went with Abram. Genesis 2:7, by contrast, shows a broader use in which *-tawh* marks material or means. That wider range should remain explicit in the grammar and stay split in the same way it is split in the candidate layer. The comitative meaning remains central, but the marker extends into associated material and instrument-like readings in ways that the English gloss *with* only partly captures.

Relator nouns

The locative and source examples already show that Tedim spatial grammar is not exhausted by a list of case markers. Relator nouns such as *lak*, *sung*, *kiang*, *tung*, *laizang*, and *vantung* regularly host locative and ablative marking, and they do so at very high frequency in the candidate-backed packet. Henderson’s structural treatment makes room for this by analyzing many such forms in terms of nominal figures rather than sharply separated case suffixes (Henderson, 1965, 59). Zam Ngaih Cing’s case system, meanwhile, makes the semantic contribution of the markers clearer (Cing, 2017, sec. 3.3.3.3).

For a final chapter, the best solution will probably be to treat the system in two layers: first the case markers themselves, then the class of relational nouns that commonly host them. The present review slice stops short of a full relator-noun section, but it already makes clear that the two layers belong in the same part of the grammar and should not be flattened into a bare suffix list.

Editorial summary

This slice now supports a modest but genuine draft chapter. Ergative *-in* can be described with a manually confirmed biblical example; *-ah* and *-pan* are already straightforward to illustrate; *-panin* can be described conservatively as a related source form; and *-tawh* can be presented with one clear accompaniment example plus one extension example. The remaining work is not to broaden the chapter, but to decide how fully the final grammar should integrate relator nouns into the same printed discussion.

References

- Henderson, Eugénie J. A. 1965. *Tiddim Chin: A Descriptive Analysis of Two Texts*. London: Oxford University Press.
- Otsuka, Kosei. 2009. “Causative and benefactive suffix -sāk in Tiddim Chin.” □□: □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ 5: 3-24.
- Singh, L. S. 2018. *A Descriptive Grammar of Sukte (Salhte)*. Imphal: Grassroot Publications.
- Zam Ngaih Cing. 2017. *A Descriptive Grammar of Tedim Chin*. PhD dissertation, North-Eastern Hill University, Shillong.

Relators / postpositions

Source slice: `output/publication_review/grammar_relators_postpositions_print_slice.md`

Editorial scope

This is the first narrow grammar slice for Tedim relators / postpositions. It is controlled by `candidates_relators_postpositions_scope.md` and `dossier_relators_postpositions_scope.md`. The generated reports `docs/grammar/reports/03-noun-04-rel` and `docs/grammar/reports/03-noun-05-postpositions.md` remain discovery or background sources only.

The case-marking packet is the boundary control for this slice: `candidates_case_marking.tsv`, `dossier_case_marking.md`, `grammar_case_marking_print_slice.md`, `dictionary_case_markers_print_slice` and `review_notes_case_marking.md` remain the main print-facing treatment of case marking. This slice is therefore not a rewrite of the case-marking packet. The relators/postpositions dictionary slice now exists at `dictionary_relators_postpositions_print_slice.md`, and review notes now exist at `review_notes_relators_postpositions.md`.

Relator nouns as relational hosts

The first-slice relator-noun anchors are *kiang*, *lak*, *sung*, *tung*, and cautiously *pualam*. These are best treated as relational nouns or relational stems that can host locative or source marking rather than as simple bare case suffixes.

Kiang is the clearest ‘beside / near / at the side of’ anchor. *Lak* is the clearest ‘among / amid / between’ anchor. *Sung* is the clearest ‘inside / within / among’ anchor. *Tung* is usable for ‘on / above / upon’, but it stays slightly closer to case-marking territory than the first three anchors and should therefore keep an explicit caveat. *Pualam* is usable for ‘outside / exterior side’, but it should remain the most cautious positive relator-noun anchor in the first slice because it still looks somewhat more lexical-nominal than *kiang*, *lak*, *sung*, or *tung*.

The point of this slice is not to deny the role of *-ah* or *-pan*. It is to keep visible that forms such as *kiang*, *lak*, *sung*, *tung*, and *pualam* contribute relational-host structure before locative or source marking is added. They are not simply bare case suffixes in disguise.

Separate and relator-hosted postpositions

The first-slice postpositional material stays deliberately narrow. *Pan* is usable only as a separate or relator-hosted source postposition, as in *kiang pan* or *lak pan*. *Panin* is usable only as a source form with structural caution. *Tawh* is usable only as a separate accompaniment or associative postposition, and it must keep its case-marking boundary caveat visible.

This slice therefore treats *pan*, *panin*, and *tawh* only where they are clearly separate or clearly relator-hosted. It does **not** replace the existing case-marking treatment of *-ah*, *-in*, *-pan*, *-panin*, or *-tawh*. The goal is to show how relator nouns and separate postpositions meet in the same constructions without reopening the settled case-marking packet.

Tawhin remains deferred or boundary-only in the first slice. The current evidence is sparse and strongly instrument-like, so it is not yet a clean postpositional anchor parallel to *pan*, *panin*, or *tawh*.

Case-marking boundary

Attached or fused-looking rows such as *kiangah*, *sungah*, *tungah*, *lakpan*, and similar forms are shared boundary territory with the case-marking packet. They are useful here because they show the relational-host side of the system, but they are not a reason to reopen the case-marking analysis or to treat every attached-looking form as an independent postposition.

This is the main value of the current grammar slice. The case-marking packet already explains the marker side of the system. The relators/postpositions slice adds value by explaining the relational-host side: why *kiang*, *lak*, *sung*, *tung*, and *pualam* matter, and why separate or relator-hosted *pan*, *panin*, and *tawh* should not be flattened into a broad inventory of suffix-like strings.

Deferred and boundary material

Several items stay outside the first grammar slice as core claims.

- *nuai* remains lower-confidence boundary material rather than a first-slice relator-noun anchor.
- *mai* remains lower-confidence boundary material because it stays close to lexical noun or body-part uses.
- *tawhin* remains deferred or boundary-only because the current evidence is sparse and instrument-like.
- Raw report counts are not evidence for the slice.
- *kipan* and *kipanin* rows involving *ki* remain boundary material rather than clean independent postpositions.
- Attached or fused-looking forms should not be promoted here as independent postpositions just because they contain *pan*, *panin*, or locative material.

Recommended next step

With `review_notes_relators_postpositions.md` now added, the packet is ready for human review at the current slice maturity level. Later work should remain narrow and case-boundary-controlled rather than broad-

ening into a new case-marking chapter.

Numerals

Source slice: `output/publication_review/grammar_numerals_print_slice.md`

Scope

This is a short print-facing draft section on numerals in Tedim Chin, controlled by `candidates_numerals.tsv` and `dossier_numerals.md`. It covers only a small candidate-backed set: basic cardinal counting phrases, compound tens, one ordinal form, one occurrence-counting or multiplicative form, one large-number phrase with caveats, and explicit ambiguity controls for *kua* and *khat*.

It does not yet attempt a full numeral paradigm, a full classifier system, a full account of distributive reduplication, quantifiers, or generated-report frequency tables. Dictionary and review-note slices have not yet begun.

Numerals in outline

The current candidate-backed packet supports a narrow generalization. Simple cardinals can follow a counted noun in examples such as *kum nih* and *ni sagih*. Compound tens are represented by *sawmkua*, ordinal formation is represented by *nihna*, occurrence-counting is represented by *sawmvei*, and large biblical number expressions are visible but need caveats. Across the packet, *kua* and *khat* require constructional controls rather than raw-string treatment.

Basic cardinal counting phrases

The cleanest basic counting phrases in the current packet are Genesis 11:10 and Genesis 7:10.

(2.27) *kúm nih*
year two
'two years'

(2.28) *nì sagih*
day seven
'seven days'

These are clean post-nominal counting phrases. The printed claim should stay modest: they show candidate-backed noun-plus-numeral counting, not a full word-order typology for every numeral construction in the language.

Compound tens

Genesis 5:9 gives the clearest current compound-ten example:

(2.29) *kúm sàwm-kua*
year ten-nine
'ninety years'

Sawmkua matters for two reasons. First, it shows a compound-ten structure. Second, it is the strongest current numeral-side control for *kua* = *nine*. The dossier also keeps one analyzer/export caveat visible: the segmentation and gloss support the compound reading, but the lemma and POS layer is flattened (*kum* | *sawm*, *N* | *N*). That caveat should stay in the prose rather than being silently normalized away.

Ordinals

Genesis 7:11 supplies the current ordinal anchor:

- (2.30) *nih-ná*
 two-NMLZ
 'second'

Nihna is the current candidate-backed ordinal example. The generated report mentions *masa* 'first', but *masa* is not promoted in this slice, and this section does not attempt a full ordinal paradigm. The dossier also records that *pos_span = N* in the export; that is a label caveat, not a reason to reject the ordinal analysis.

Occurrence counting / multiplicative form

Genesis 31:7 keeps one compact occurrence-counting form in view:

- (2.31) *sàwm-véi*
 ten-times
 'ten times'

The generated report paraphrases this as *vei sawm*, but the candidate layer uses export-backed *sawmvei*, and that fused form should control the present slice. This row is enough to keep occurrence-counting visible, but it is not enough to build a full classifier system.

Large-number phrase

Genesis 5:27 gives one usable large-number phrase, but only with explicit caveats:

- (2.32) *kúm zā-kua* *lè kúm sàwm-gùk* *lè kua*
 year hundred-nine and year ten-six and who
 'nine hundred sixty and nine years' (Genesis 5:27)

This construction is numeral, not interrogative. The dossier is nevertheless explicit about the export caveats: the analyzer compresses *zā-kua*, and the final *kua* is glossed as *who* in the candidate TSV even though the constructional context is numeral. The print gloss therefore keeps *nine* reader-facing while marking the export gloss in the example line. This makes the row usable with caveat, but not a fully polished anchor for a larger large-number section.

Kua ambiguity

Kua needs an explicit control note in the printed grammar. In constructionally numeral contexts such as *sawmkua* and the Genesis 5:27 large-number phrase, *kua* is numeral *nine*. In interrogative clauses, however, *kua* is also *who*.

The blocked control in the numerals packet is Genesis 48:8:

Hihte kua ahi hiam?

That row belongs to the interrogatives packet, not to numerals. Future numerals prose must therefore not use raw *kua* hits as numeral evidence.

Khat and the numeral/indefinite boundary

Genesis 32:24 gives a useful but boundary-marked example:

- (2.33) *mì khàt*
 person one
 'a man' / 'one person'

Mi khat is analyzer-backed and worth keeping visible, but its English context “a man” shows why it should not be treated as an uncomplicated bare numeral *one* example. The packet therefore keeps it as numeral/indefinite boundary evidence and does not start a quantifiers retrofit here.

Distributive reduplication deferred

The generated report claims distributive *sagih sagih* for ‘by sevens’, but the candidate layer keeps that material deferred. In the current analyzer export window, Genesis 7:2 preserves only a single *sagih* token. Distributive reduplication therefore remains not print-ready in this slice, and *sagih sagih* should not be printed as though it were already analyzer-backed.

Editorial summary

This slice now safely supports six modest claims: noun-plus-numeral counting examples are printable; compound-ten *sawmkua* is candidate-backed; ordinal *nihna* is candidate-backed; occurrence-counting *sawmvei* remains visible with a fused-export caveat; one large-number phrase is usable with explicit analyzer caveats; and the packet has explicit controls for *kua* and *khat*.

What remains deferred is equally important: raw frequency counts, full numeral paradigms, *masa*, distributive reduplication, a full classifier system, quantifier overlap, and raw *kua* matching. The next step after this grammar slice is the dictionary print slice, while review-note work has not yet begun.

Quantifiers

Source slice: *output/publication_review/grammar_quantifiers_print_slice.md*

Scope

This is a short print-facing draft section on quantifiers in Tedim Chin, controlled by *candidates_quantifiers.tsv* and *dossier_quantifiers.md*.

It covers only a small candidate-backed set: universal *khempeuh*; partitive or existential *pawlkhat* with caveat; *khat* as numeral/indefinite boundary evidence; negative-licensed quantifiers *kuamah* and *bangmah*; degree or quantity *tampi tak*; comparative and intensifier edge rows with *zaw* and *mahmah*; deferred *peuhpeuh* and *tawm*; and blocked bang-family false-friend material.

It does not yet attempt a full quantifier system, a full universal or distributive system, a full indefinite or partitive account, a full negative-quantifier chapter, a full degree/intensifier/comparative chapter, or generated-report frequency tables. Dictionary and review-note slices have not yet begun.

Quantifiers in outline

The current candidate-backed packet supports a narrow generalization. *Khempeuh* currently provides the safest universal-quantifier anchor. *Pawlkhat* is useful, but the accepted example remains partitive or alternative-grouping evidence rather than a plain bare *some*. *Khat* remains boundary evidence shared with numerals. *Kuamah* and *bangmah* are usable only in negative-licensed contexts. *Tampi tak* is the main degree or quantity row. *Zaw* and *mahmah* are edge rows only, and *peuhpeuh* plus *tawm* remain visible but deferred.

Universal quantifier *khempeuh*

Genesis 2:1 supplies the current candidate-backed universal anchor:

- (2.34) *vàn-tùng léi-tùng lè à sùng-à òm-tè khèmpeuh*
sky-on land-on and 3SG inside-3SG exist-PL all
‘the heavens and the earth, and all that was in them’ (Genesis 2:1)

Khempeuh is the current accepted universal anchor. The example is a scoped noun phrase, not a license for raw *khempeuh* harvesting or for generated-report count claims. The printed claim should therefore stay modest: the current packet supports one clear universal anchor, not a complete universal-quantifier system.

Partitive / existential *pawlkhath*

Genesis 32:8 gives the current accepted-with-caveat *pawlkhath* row:

- (2.35) *pàwl-khàt*
some-one
'one group' / 'one company'

Pawlkhath is useful, but the context is partitive or alternative grouping ("one company ... the other company"), not an uncomplicated bare *some*. The dossier is also explicit that the noisy opening *Pawlkhatath* token should not be substituted for the clean later *pawlkhath* control token.

***Khat* and the numeral/indefinite boundary**

Genesis 32:24 provides the current boundary row:

- (2.36) *mì khàt*
person one
'a man' / 'one person'

Mi khat is reused from the numerals packet as boundary evidence. It prevents quantifiers from silently absorbing numeral *khat* as an article-like quantifier. The present slice therefore does not treat *khat* as an uncomplicated quantifier anchor, and it does not reopen the numerals packet here.

Negative quantifiers and negation overlap

The current packet prints *kuamah* and *bangmah* only in negative-licensed clauses.

- (2.37) *kuamah mú lò*
nobody see.I NEG
'he saw nobody' / 'he saw no man'

- (2.38) *bangmah òm lò hì*
nothing exist NEG DECL
'there is nothing' / 'nothing exists'

These rows are accepted with caveat only in negative-licensed contexts. This grammar slice should therefore cross-reference, not reopen, the stabilized negation packet. Raw *kuamah* or *bangmah* hits should not be treated as print evidence unless the clause is checked and the negative licensing is explicit.

Bang-family false friends

The packet also keeps one blocked control visible:

Blocked control: *tua bangmah hi-in*

This Exodus 27:11 row is not ordinary negative-quantifier evidence. Its function in the packet is to prevent quantifiers from absorbing *bangmah* outside clear negative licensing. That control also respects the stabilized interrogatives packet, where bang-family false friends had to be handled separately from ordinary question material.

Degree / quantity *tampi*

Genesis 17:2 gives the current degree or quantity anchor:

- (2.39) *tampi tak*
many truly
'exceedingly' / 'very many'

Tampi tak is enough to keep degree or quantity material visible in the first slice. It should not, however, launch a full adjective or adverb chapter.

Comparative and intensifier edge rows

The packet keeps one comparative and one intensifier row visible, but only as edge material:

- (2.40) *vang-lian zàw*
power-big more
'more powerful' / 'mightier'

- (2.41) *hau màhmàh*
rich very
'very rich'

Zaw and *mahmah* are useful boundary evidence. They are not the basis for a full comparison or intensifier chapter in this slice, and they should remain caveated edge rows rather than prompts for a broad degree-modification analysis.

Deferred material

Two visible rows remain deferred.

First, *peuhpeuh* is represented by *mi peuhpeuh*, but that row remains deferred because the example behaves more like free-choice *whoever* / *any person* material than like settled distributive-universal evidence. It is therefore not print-ready in the present slice.

Second, *tawm* remains deferred because the current export glosses it as *produce*, and the low-quantity reading is still too noisy for print promotion. The current slice also leaves fuller universal/distributive, comparative, degree/intensifier, and negative-quantifier systems deferred. Coordinators and sentence-final particles remain outside scope.

Editorial summary

This slice safely supports six modest claims: *khempeuh* is the current universal anchor; *pawlkhat* is usable as partitive or existential evidence with caveat; *khat* is visible only as numeral/indefinite boundary evidence; *kuamah* and *bangmah* are usable as negative-licensed quantifier evidence; *tampi tak* is the current degree/quantity anchor; and *zaw* plus *mahmah* remain caveated edge rows.

What remains deferred is equally important: raw frequency counts, *peuhpeuh* as settled distributive-universal evidence, *tawm* as settled low-quantity evidence, *bangmah* outside clear negative licensing, *khat* as an uncomplicated article-like quantifier, a full degree/intensifier/comparative chapter, and any move into coordinators or sentence-final particles. The next step after this grammar slice is the dictionary print slice, while review-note work has not yet begun.

Predicate structure and verbal morphology

Stem alternation

Source slice: *output/publication_review/grammar_stem_alternation_print_slice.md*

Verb-stem alternation

This file is now a **draft argument plan**, not the final polished grammar section. The eventual prose should not be organized only by print status. It should discuss **both syntactic contexts and individual verb pairs**, in that order:

1. system-wide Form I / Form II distribution by syntactic context;
2. the strongest illustrative pairs;
3. pair-by-pair caveated and difficult evidence;
4. one-sided, control, and rejected material.

Earlier descriptions agree that Tedim has a two-form verbal system, even though the terminology differs. Henderson describes Form I and Form II, while Zam Ngaih Cing speaks of Stem 1 and Stem 2 (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017). The present review packet keeps those descriptive traditions in view, but it now separates coverage, promotion, and quotation safety much more explicitly than the earlier broad analyzer table did.

The Form I / Form II contrast The opening section of the eventual grammar should introduce the system with the strongest lexical pairs, not with the widest possible inventory.

- **Core starting point:** *mu ~ muh, ne ~ nek, nei ~ neih*.
- **Basic descriptive claim:** Form I is especially clear in ordinary finite predication and many main-clause uses. Form II is especially visible in dependent, temporal, purposive, attributive, nominalized, and other constructionally bound environments.
- **Immediate caution:** do not reduce the system to slogans such as *Form II = subordinate*, *Form II = negative*, *Form I = finite*, or *Form II = nominalized only*.

The argument here should stay structural and distributional before it becomes lexical and pair-specific.

The eventual section will likely need five editorial surfaces:

- a **small core showcase table**;
- a **larger promoted-pair inventory table**;
- a **pair-by-pair discussion section**;
- a **one-sided / same-form / functional coverage table**;
- a **blocked or analyzer-noise table / appendix paragraph**.

Distribution by syntactic context The main organizing file for this part of the write-up is `output/publication_review/`. The matrix is for organizing claims and subsection order; the citation shortlist remains the source of quotation candidates. The prose should work through the following contexts in order, using the matrix rather than treating all environments as equivalent evidence.

Finite and main-clause uses Start with ordinary finite predication. This is where Form I is clearest, even though some lexical pairs still show real Form II matrix tokens.

Imperatives and directives Use imperatives and directives to reinforce the ordinary clause-force profile of Form I, while noting that some lexical pairs still show marked Form II directive material.

Negative clauses Negative clauses belong in the argument, but they are **not** a single diagnostic. The prose should say that negative environments matter, not that Form II simply equals negation.

Dependent temporal clauses with *ciangin* This is one of the strongest places to show Form II in clearly dependent syntax. It should be one of the central distributional subsections.

Temporal and nominal *ni-in* contexts Use *ni-in* as a second temporal construction so the grammar does not make *ciangin* carry the whole dependent-clause argument.

Clause-linking with *kipan* This subsection is especially important for pairs such as *nusia ~ nusiat*, where the best Form II evidence is constructionally bound and source-linking rather than a neat finite contrast.

Purposive *nadingin* Purposive or irrealis-heavy *ding / nadingin* clauses are one of the clearest places where Form II becomes prominent across several promoted pairs.

Nominalized *-na* Nominalized material should be discussed directly, but with an explicit filter against lexicalized nouns and compounds.

Attributive and relative *mi* contexts These contexts belong with the broader non-final distribution. They matter, but they should not be turned into a mechanical rule.

Possessed and genitive attributive contexts This section should stay compact and should probably center on *nei ~ neih*, since that pair gives the clearest evidence here.

Modal and ability uses This subsection should explicitly center on *thei ~ theih*, since the pair is real but constructionally special.

Quotative and say-complement contexts Discuss this environment mainly to explain why functional material such as *ci ~ cih* should not be merged blindly into the lexical-verb showcase table.

Derived, causative, compound, and lexicalized material This should be an explicit filter section, not a positive-evidence section. The grammar needs to show why *-sak* material, compounds, lexicalized families, and review-bucket rows cannot simply be counted as ordinary stem evidence.

Core showcase pairs The core pair subsection should remain narrow and should illustrate the system with the strongest three pairs:

- *mu ~ muh*
- *ne ~ nek*
- *nei ~ neih*

These pairs should do the main pedagogical work for the Form I / Form II contrast.

This should become the **small core showcase table**, not the full promoted inventory.

Promoted caveated pairs The next section should move to the broader but still promoted inventory:

- *za ~ zak*
- *pia ~ piak*
- *nusia ~ nusiat*
- *bia ~ biak*
- *thei ~ theih*
- *piang ~ pian*
- *zui ~ zuih*
- *khial ~ khialh*
- *kia ~ kiak*
- *sawlkhia ~ sawlkhiat*

Each pair should get a short paragraph or table note answering two questions:

1. **What does the evidence positively show?**
2. **What is the specific caveat?**

The point is not to collapse them into one generic “caveated examples” bucket, but to say what kind of Form II evidence each pair contributes.

This should likely become the **larger promoted-pair inventory table**, with short editorial notes rather than long prose for every row.

Difficult but grammatically important pairs This section should keep the difficult cases in the argument rather than silently dropping them:

- *ngai ~ ngaih*
- *pua ~ puak*
- *pai ~ paih*
- *tua ~ tuah*
- *tua ~ tuak*

These are not simply rejected. They matter because they show lexical-family contamination, shared-base problems, one-sided evidence, and analyzer overgeneration.

One-sided Bible attestations and questionnaire controls This section should separate two things that were too easily blurred in earlier drafts:

1. **One-sided or constructionally skewed lexical verbs** such as *bawl ~ bawlh*, *dipkua ~ dipkuat*, *gen ~ genh*, *hawlkhia ~ hawlkhiat*, *husia ~ husiat*, *kho ~ khoh*, *kido ~ kidot*, *lua ~ luah*, *tu ~ tuh*, *tuahpha ~ tuahphat*, and *vial ~ vialh*.
2. **Same-form questionnaire controls** such as *dawn ~ dawn*, *hong ~ hong*, *om ~ om*, *ci ~ ci*, *hi ~ hi*, *bawl ~ bawl*, *zui ~ zui*, *pai ~ pai*, and the other same-form rows now tracked in the lexical inventory.

The prose should say clearly that same-form questionnaire rows are useful controls, but they are not overt alternating pairs in the Bible layer.

These rows are **not** discarded. They should stay visible in a coverage table because the grammar needs to account for verbs flagged by the literature, questionnaire, analyzer inventory, and Bible audit even when only one side is cleanly attested in the current Bible layer.

Rejected/non-verbal/analyzer-noise cases This section should explain why some apparent pairs stay blocked:

- nouns and nominal compounds;
- lexicalized or compound families;
- derivational *-sak* material;
- homophones and shared-base contamination;
- category mismatches;
- analyzer overgeneration.

Representative blocked rows should include:

- *keu ~ keuh*
- *khai ~ khaih*
- *sia ~ siah*
- *tan ~ tanh*
- *mual ~ mualh*

- *sum ~ sumh*
- *thu ~ thuh*
- *lampi ~ lampih*
- *khua ~ khuat*
- *gamlā ~ gamlat*

How the evidence files should be used The final prose should keep the current evidence layers distinct:

- `output/publication_review/stem_alteration_citation_shortlist.tsv` = the **only quotation-safe layer** for printed examples.
- `output/publication_review/stem_alteration_syntactic_context_matrix.tsv` = the basis for the **context-by-context distributional argument** and for organizing claims by subsection.
- `output/publication_review/stem_alteration_pair_discussion_plan.tsv` = the basis for the **pair-by-pair discussion order and claims**.
- `output/publication_review/stem_alteration_lexical_inventory.tsv` = the coverage layer for lexical category, promotion status, blockers, and source basis.
- `output/publication_review/stem_alteration_promotable_examples.tsv` and `output/publication_review/stem_alteration_blocked_noise_examples.tsv` = editorial support files for promotion and example triage.
- `output/publication_review/stem_alteration_corpus_audit.tsv` = generated local background evidence; useful for checking rows, but not a quotation-safe layer and not a tracked argument table.

Writing order for the eventual section The actual grammar section should be drafted in this order:

1. **System-wide syntactic distribution**
2. **Best-attested showcase pairs**
3. **Promoted and difficult pair-by-pair discussion**
4. **One-sided / same-form / functional coverage table**
5. **Blocked or analyzer-noise appendix paragraph**

That is the architecture this packet should now support.

Next prose draft The next commit should create a separate prose draft file rather than overwrite this planning file, probably at `output/publication_review/grammar_stem_alteration_section_draft.md`.

That draft should be organized as:

1. **System-wide syntactic distribution**
2. **Core showcase examples**
3. **Promoted-pair inventory**
4. **Pair-by-pair notes for promoted and difficult pairs**
5. **One-sided / same-form / functional coverage table**
6. **Blocked/noise appendix paragraph**

Verb paradigms

[MAJOR GAP: verb paradigms remain report-backed but not packet-shaped.]

`docs/grammar/reports/05-verb-00-paradigm-tables.md` remains part of the evidence base, but it has not yet been converted into a review-note-stage packet with an assembled grammar slice.

Prefix / agreement

Source slice: `output/publication_review/grammar_prefix_agreement_print_slice.md`

Editorial scope

This is the first narrow prefix/agreement grammar slice for Tedim. It is controlled by `output/publication_review/candic` and `output/publication_review/dossier_prefix_agreement_scope.md`. Supporting/background evidence comes from `docs/grammar/reports/05-verb-03-agreement.md`, `docs/grammar/reports/04-np-07-posses`, `docs/grammar/morphemes/01-prefixes.md`, `docs/grammar/lit-reviews/04-np-07-possession-lit.md`, `docs/grammar/DISAMBIGUATION.md`, and the regression evidence in `tests/test_prefix_agr_poss.py`.

This is not a full agreement chapter, not a full possession chapter, not a full object-prefix or inverse chapter, and not a rewrite of the completed pronouns/clusivity packet. It also stays narrow against `output/publication_review/review_notes_pronouns.md`, `output/publication_review/review_notes_deriv` and `output/publication_review/review_notes_vp_structure_stacking.md`.

The present slice therefore covers only the agreement-versus-possession routing contrast, with *kanei* as the clearest agreement anchor and *kainn* as the clearest possessive-routing anchor. No dictionary slice exists yet for prefix/agreement, because this packet is still establishing a controlled routing claim rather than a lexical headword layer. The packet now proceeds through review notes rather than through a lexical headword layer.

Agreement versus possession routing

The first safe prefix/agreement claim is a routing contrast. Before verbs, the shared pronominal prefix family may be routed as agreement; before nouns, the same family may be routed as possession.

Kanei and *kainn* are the core pair for that contrast. *Kanei* keeps the prefix family on a verbal host, while *kainn* keeps it on a nominal host. `tests/test_prefix_agr_poss.py` is the key regression control here, because it explicitly requires verb-side AGR glossing to stay distinct from noun-side POSS glossing.

That is enough for the first print-facing claim. The slice does not need to resolve every larger prefix question before stating that host type already controls a safe agreement-versus-possession routing contrast in the current candidate layer.

Agreement anchor: kanei

Kanei is the clearest verbal agreement anchor in the packet. The candidate TSV marks it as the main AGR-side row, and `tests/test_prefix_agr_poss.py` protects the glossing as *ka-nei* / *ISG-have*.

The grammar claim here is deliberately limited. At the current slice maturity level, *kanei* supports only the routing statement that the shared prefix family can surface as verbal agreement before a verb host. This is strong enough for a narrow print slice, but still smaller than a full agreement chapter or a full prefix paradigm.

Possessive anchor: kainn

Kainn is the clearest possessive-routing anchor in the packet. The candidate TSV marks it as the nominal counterpart to *kanei*, and `tests/test_prefix_agr_poss.py` protects the glossing as *ka-inn* / *ISG.POSS-house*.

The grammar claim again stays small. At the current slice maturity level, *kainn* supports the routing statement that the same prefix family can be analyzed as possessive before a noun host. This is enough to justify a first print-facing contrast without pretending that the project already has a full possession chapter or a full possessor-syntax account.

Why this is not just pronouns again

The completed pronouns/clusivity packet already handles independent pronouns, clusivity, and the broader pronoun paradigm through `output/publication_review/review_notes_pronouns.md`.

This slice is doing something narrower. It is about prefix routing across verbal and nominal hosts, not about reopening the independent-pronoun paradigm. That is why *kanei* and *kainn* are better first anchors here than *ipai*, *ko*, *ei*, or any broader person-paradigm table.

Boundary material

The rest of the candidate packet stays outside the first grammar slice because each row is still dominated by another unresolved boundary.

ainn stays outside because the broader *a-* family overlaps with verbal agreement, relativizer-like material, and other domains. It is useful boundary evidence, but not the first clean routing anchor.

ipai stays outside because inclusive/exclusive *i-* material belongs first to the completed pronouns/clusivity packet rather than to this first routing slice.

hongmu and *kongmu* stay outside because object-prefix or inverse-like material still needs a later dedicated sub-scope with tighter directional and inverse controls.

kipan stays outside because *ki-* reflexive or middle material remains boundary-only between prefix/agreement and derivation/valency.

Apostrophe possession and broader possessor syntax also stay outside because this is not a full possession chapter.

Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest prefix/agreement claim is that Tedim has candidate-controlled evidence for routing a shared pronominal prefix family differently by host type: *kanei* supports verbal agreement routing, while *kainn* supports nominal possessive routing.

That claim is deliberately smaller than a full agreement chapter, smaller than a full possession chapter, smaller than a full object-prefix or inverse chapter, and smaller than a rewritten pronoun packet.

Recommended next step

This packet now properly proceeds to prefix/agreement review notes rather than to a dictionary slice, because it is a routing/analysis packet rather than a lexical headword packet.

If the project later wants one more prefix step after review notes and human review, the next sub-scope should be a separate hong-/kong- object-prefix or inverse candidate expansion rather than a dictionary layer.

Transitivity

Source slice: `output/publication_review/grammar_transitivity_print_slice.md`

Editorial scope

This is the first narrow transitivity grammar slice. It is controlled by `output/publication_review/candidates_transitivity` and `output/publication_review/dossier_transitivity_scope.md`. Supporting/background evidence comes from `docs/grammar/reports/05-verb-12-transitivity.md`.

Boundary control comes from `output/publication_review/review_notes_derivation_valency.md`, `output/publication_review/review_notes_stem_alternation.md`, `output/publication_review/review_notes_vp_structure_stacking.md`, `output/publication_review/review_notes_case_marking.md`, and `output/publication_review/review_notes_case_marking.md`.

This is not a full valency chapter, not a full verb-class chapter, not a dictionary slice, and not a full argument-structure account.

Clean intransitive anchor: *sih*

sih is the clean intransitive anchor for the first slice. The controlled form and gloss/function are *sih* / *die*.

The claim stays narrow. `output/publication_review/candidates_transitivity.tsv` and `output/publication_review/` treat *sih* as the safest current intransitive anchor because it is a simple ABS-led event row that does not im-

mediately force derivation/valency, prefix/agreement, or case-marking analysis into the first print-facing claim.

Supporting intransitive row: *suak*

suak is supporting intransitive evidence rather than the sole anchor. The controlled form and gloss/function are *suak / become*.

That makes *suak* useful as a second row for the intransitive side of the contrast. It supports a narrow change-of-state intransitive reading without forcing the slice to generalize over the whole report-level intransitive inventory.

Clean transitive anchor: *hawl*

hawl is the clean transitive anchor for the first slice. The controlled form and gloss/function are *hawl / seek*.

The claim here also stays narrow. *hawl* is the safest current transitive anchor because it gives the packet a simple transitive event row without leaning on derivation-heavy material such as *piangsak* or stem-family material such as *ngai / ngaih*. The report percentages in `docs/grammar/reports/05-verb-12-transitivity.md` are useful discovery evidence, but they are not treated here as categorical proof.

Supporting transitive row: *en*

en is supporting transitive evidence rather than the leading transitive claim. The controlled form and gloss/function are *en / look.at*.

That makes *en* useful as secondary support for the transitive side of the slice. It helps confirm the narrow contrast, but lower counts and perception-verb semantics make it weaker than *hawl* as a chapter-leading anchor.

Why ambitransitive/labile material is not yet the first slice

mu / muh remains visible boundary evidence for alternation or labile-looking behavior. It matters because it shows that the transitivity report is not exhausted by a clean binary class split.

It stays outside the first print-facing claim, however, because *mu / muh* overlaps directly with Form I / Form II stem alternation. The same caution applies to *za / zak*, *nei / neih*, and *ngai / ngaih*, which remain candidate-layer or boundary material rather than anchors for this commit.

Boundary material

The following stay outside the first grammar slice:

- *mu / muh*
- *za / zak*
- *nei / neih*
- *ngai / ngaih*
- *piangsak*
- *pia*
- *gen*
- *tom*
- *hong*
- *ki*
- *dawt*

- *bei*
- *pia(k)sak*
- case-dominated rows
- derivation-heavy rows
- prefix/agreement-heavy rows
- analyzer-noisy, lexicalized, report-only, or whole-system verb-class claims

piangsak remains outside because it is derivation/valency-heavy and lexicalized-looking. *pia*, *gen*, and *tom* remain outside because they are dominated by broader case-marking and argument-structure interpretation. *hong* and *ki* remain outside because their report behavior is too mixed for the first clean intransitive claim. *dawt*, *bei*, and *pia(k)sak* remain outside because they are too thin, too noisy, or too report-bound for the first print-facing contrast.

Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest transitivity claim is that Tedim has candidate-controlled evidence for a narrow intransitive/transitive contrast, with *sih* and *suak* supporting the intransitive side and *hawl*, with secondary support from *en*, supporting the transitive side.

Alternation, labile behavior, stem alternation, derivation/valency, prefix/agreement, case-marking, and whole-system verb-class claims remain candidate-layer or boundary material.

Recommended next step

After this grammar slice, the next step should be transitivity review notes rather than a dictionary slice, because this packet is grammar-facing and argument-structure-oriented rather than lexical.

If more transitivity work is chosen before review notes, the next sub-scope should be *mu* / *muh* as a labile or stem-alternation boundary packet, but not in this commit.

VP structure / suffix stacking

Source slice: `output/publication_review/grammar_vp_structure_stacking_print_slice.md`

Editorial scope

This is the first narrow VP structure / suffix stacking grammar slice for Tedim. It is controlled by `output/publication_review/candidates_vp_structure_stacking.tsv` and `output/publication_review/docs/grammar/background_evidence` comes from `docs/grammar/reports/05-verb-02-vp-structure.md`, `docs/grammar/reports/05-verb-10-combinations.md`, and the regression evidence in `tests/test_vp_slots.py`.

This is not a full VP chapter. It is not a rewrite of TAM, directionals, negation, sentence-final particles, or relators/postpositions. Those packet boundaries remain explicit through `output/publication_review/review_notes_tam.md`, `output/publication_review/review_notes_directionals.md`, `output/publication_review/review_notes_sentence_final_particles.md`, and `output/publication_review/review_notes_relators_postpositions.md`.

The present slice therefore covers only the first safe suffix-stacking claim: *bawlzoding* as the central print-usable-with-caveat anchor for aspect plus irrealis stacking. No ordinary dictionary slice exists for this packet because it is constructional rather than lexical.

Baseline: completed single-suffix packets

The packet starts from two completed single-suffix baselines that are already owned elsewhere.

bawlzo remains the compact V+ASPECT baseline already owned by the TAM packet. It shows that the repository already has a stable completive anchor, but it should be used here only as baseline evidence rather than reopened as new VP-structure prose.

pokhia remains the compact V+DIR baseline already owned by the directionals packet. It shows that the repository already has a stable post-stem directional anchor, but it should be used here only as baseline evidence rather than widened into a new VP-slot claim.

These baseline rows matter because the first VP slice should not redescribe already-completed packets. Their role here is only to show that compact single-suffix material is already controlled before a multi-suffix claim is added.

First stacking anchor: aspect plus irrealis

bawlzoding is the central first-slice stack. The candidate layer marks it as *print_usable_with_caveat*, and `tests/test_vp_slots.py` already keeps it visible as aspect-plus-modal regression evidence.

The safe print claim is deliberately narrow. *bawlzoding* supports the ordering observation:

verb stem + completive/aspectual material + irrealis/modal material

In other words, the current slice supports a small VP-structure claim that aspectual material can precede irrealis/modal material inside a multi-suffix verbal complex.

For the present packet, that means reading *bawlzoding* as a constructional stack rather than over-trusting every analyzer label on the row. The current analyzer gloss is noisy (`make-south-IRR`), so the slice should not pretend that the middle gloss is already a perfect semantic label. The point of the row is its suffix-stacking evidence: the repository already has a regression-backed form in which a verbal stem is followed by completive/aspectual material and then by irrealis/modal material.

This is enough for a first grammar slice, but not enough for a full VP slot template. The present packet therefore treats *bawlzoding* as the clearest current anchor for aspect plus irrealis stacking and stops there.

Boundary and deferred stacks

The rest of the visible stacks remain outside the first core slice because each one is dominated by another packet boundary.

khia-ta is useful boundary evidence because it shows real TAM/directional overlap, but it is not the first-slice core. The completed TAM and directionals packets already keep this row visible as overlap evidence, and this slice should not reopen either packet through that row.

ciahsakkik, *bawlsakthei*, and *paikhiatsak* are real multi-suffix complexes, but they are derivation/valency-heavy stacks. Once *-sak* and other valency-changing material become central, the next packet boundary is derivation/valency rather than narrow VP stacking. These rows therefore stay deferred until the derivation/valency packet is explicitly selected.

khiathei ding om lo is also real overlap evidence, but it is TAM-negation overlap rather than a clean first VP-stack anchor. The completed negation and TAM packets already control that territory, so it should not be promoted as the model for core VP-stacking prose.

dingin remains clause-bound irrealis or subordination material. It is important because it shows how quickly visible verbal stacking can turn into clause-linkage evidence, but it should wait for a subordination packet rather than being promoted here as simple VP suffix stacking.

Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest VP-structure claim is that Tedim permits at least some multi-suffix verbal complexes in which aspectual material precedes irrealis/modal material, with *bawlzoding* as the clearest current anchor.

That claim stays deliberately smaller than a full slot template. It does not claim that every visible stack in the reports belongs to one solved VP order, and it does not reopen completed TAM, directional, negation, sentence-final, or relator/postposition packets.

Recommended next step

After this grammar slice, the packet can move to review notes without forcing an ordinary dictionary slice, because the safe first-slice claim is constructional rather than lexical.

The next substantive packet after this narrow constructional slice should therefore be derivation/valency candidate scoping rather than a broader VP rewrite.

TAM / aspect / modal

Source slice: *output/publication_review/grammar_tam_print_slice.md*

Editorial scope

This is the first narrow TAM / aspect / modal grammar slice for Tedim Chin, controlled by *candidates_tam.tsv* and *dossier_tam_scope.md*. It is not a full TAM chapter.

The first-slice TAM anchors are limited to *-ngei*, *-gige*, *-zel*, *-ta*, *-zo*, *-kik*, *-ding*, and *-thei*, represented here by *paingei*, *neigige*, *paizel*, *kilawmta*, *bawlzo*, *hongpaikik*, *omding*, and *bawlthei*. This slice therefore stays with compact suffixal anchors already marked print-ready or print-usable in the candidate TSV instead of widening into broad clause-structure, sentence-final, directional, or VP-slot prose. The dictionary slice now exists, but review-note work has not yet begun.

Experiential and habitual anchors

Paingei (*pai-ngei* → *go-EXP*) is the current experiential anchor. It supports the narrow claim that *-ngei* can mark experiential meaning such as ‘have V-ed before’ when it stays tied to a compact verbal host.

Neigige (*nei-gige* → *have-HAB*) is the current habitual anchor. It supports a modest print claim that *-gige* can mark habitual or regularly repeated action.

Paizel (*pai-zel* → *go-HAB.CONT*) is the current habitual-continuative anchor. It is usable, but it borders broader continuative aspect and should stay construction-controlled. The first TAM slice should therefore keep *-zel* tied to compact anchors such as *paizel* rather than turning every continuative-looking or lexicalized *zel* sequence into TAM evidence.

Compact aspectual anchors

Kilawmta (*ki-lawm-ta* → *REFL-worthy-PFV*) is the current compact perfective anchor. It supports a modest completed-event reading for *-ta*, but only with sentence-final overlap caveat. The slice relies on compact suffixed verbs, not bare *ta*, and it keeps sentence-final overlap material such as *mangngilh ta hi* outside the core TAM evidence.

Bawlzo (*bawl-zo* → *make-COMPL*) is the current compact completive anchor. It supports a modest ‘finish V-ing’ or completive reading for *-zo*, but only with the bare-*zo* and sentence-final overlap caveat kept explicit. The slice therefore treats *bawlzo* as usable compact evidence while refusing to turn bare *zo* into default TAM proof.

Hongpaikik (*hong-pai-kik* → *3→I-go-ITER*) is the current iterative anchor. It is usable as iterative or ‘again’ evidence, but it should not become a motion/return chapter. The first slice keeps *-kik* narrow and construction-backed rather than expanding it into every return- or motion-flavored verbal sequence.

Compact modal anchors

Omding (*om-ding* → *exist-IRR*) is the current compact *-ding* anchor. It supports a narrow irrealis / future / modal claim, but only with the explicit dingin and clause-bound caveat. *Dingin* and other clause-bound *-ding* material

stay outside the starting print slice, so *omding* remains the safer anchor than report-style purposive or clause-linking material.

Bawlthei (*bawl-thei* -> make-ABIL) is the current compact abilitative anchor. It supports a narrow ‘can / be able’ reading for *-thei*, but only with the negation/irrealis-stack caveat kept explicit. Negative-modal strings such as *khiathei ding om lo* remain overlap controls rather than core evidence for this first slice.

Deferred and overlap material

The following items remain out of this first grammar slice:

- *pailai*, because *-lai* still overlaps lexical *lai* / *go-midst* material and is not yet a clean prospective anchor;
- *dingin* and other clause-bound *-ding* material;
- negative modal stacks such as *khiathei ding om lo*;
- sentence-final overlap such as *mangngilh ta hi*;
- directional/TAM stacking such as *khia-ta*;
- broader VP-slot stacks such as *bawlzoding* and *bawlsakthei*;
- report-summary items such as *-nawn* and *-khin* until cleaner anchors are selected.

These forms stay visible as overlap or deferred controls, but they do not belong to the first compact TAM grammar slice.

Recommended next step

After this grammar slice, the next step is the TAM dictionary print slice drafted against the same `candidates_tam.tsv` and `dossier_tam_scope.md`; that slice now exists, and review-note work has not yet begun. Broad TAM rewrite work remains out of scope.

Directionals

Source slice: `output/publication_review/grammar_directionals_print_slice.md`

Scope

This is a short print-facing draft section on directionals in Tedim Chin, controlled by `candidates_directionals.tsv` and `dossier_directionals.md`.

It covers only a small candidate-backed set: outward *-khia*, anchored by *pokhia*; away *-khiat*, anchored by *nawhkhiat*; nominalized *-khiat-na* boundary material, represented by *hotkhiatna*; upward *-toh*, anchored by *ki-laktah*; nominalized *-toh-na* boundary material, represented by *kahtohna*; blocked comitative/accompany *-toh* overlap, represented by *paitoh*; direction/side/manner *-lam* boundary material, represented by *tawplam*; cautious toward *-sawn* evidence, represented by *piasawn*; downward *-suk* evidence, represented by *paisuk*; and deferred *-lut*, *-phei*, *-cip*, plus *-tang*.

It does not yet attempt a full VP-slot chapter, a full TAM or aspect account, a full inventory from raw suffix counts, or a treatment of all lexicalized directional-looking forms. Dictionary and review-note slices have not yet begun.

Directionals in outline

The current candidate-backed packet supports a narrow generalization. Directionals are visible here as suffixed verbal or verbal-derived forms in the candidate layer. The clearest first anchors are *pokhia*, *nawhkhiat*, *kilaktah*, *piasawn*, and *paisuk*. Nominalized forms such as *hotkhiatna* and *kahtohna* are useful boundary evidence but are not identical to finite directional verbs. *-toh* requires an explicit comitative/accompany warning because *paitoh* is blocked as lexicalized *go-accompany*. *-lam* remains direction/side/manner boundary material rather than a clean simple verbal suffix in the current packet. *-lut*, *-phei*, *-cip*, and *-tang* remain deferred or not print-ready.

Outward *-khia*

Genesis 2:5 supplies the cleanest current outward anchor:

- (3.42) *po-khìa*
grow-out
'grew'

Pokhia is the cleanest current outward *-khia* anchor. It supports a modest print claim that *-khia* can mark outward motion or direction.

That claim must stay narrow. The row does **not** license raw *khia* harvesting or a claim that every orthographic *khia* sequence is directional evidence.

Away *-khiat* and nominalized *-khiat-na*

Deuteronomy 9:4 supplies the current away anchor:

- (3.43) *nawh-khiat*
hurry-away
'cast them out'

Nawhkhiat is the current compact away *-khiat* anchor. It is accepted with caveat because the export still labels the selected lemma/POS as *nawh* / *N*. The example is therefore usable as construction-backed away evidence with an analyzer label caution, not as an uncomplicated finite-verb showcase.

Future prose should keep *-khiat* construction-controlled rather than treating every *...khiat* token as the same directional claim.

Exodus 14:13 then keeps nominalized boundary material visible:

- (3.44) *hot-khiat-ná*
save-away-NMLZ
'salvation'

Hotkhiatna keeps *-khiat-na* visible in the packet. It is nominalized boundary material and should not be treated as identical to a finite directional predicate.

Upward *-toh* and comitative/accompany overlap

Numbers 9:17 supplies the current upward anchor:

- (3.45) *kī-làk-tòh*
REFL-take-UP
'was taken up'

Kilaktòh is the current upward *-toh* anchor. It is usable only with the packet's polysemy caveat: this row supports upward *-toh*, but it does not license a raw equation of *-toh* = *UP*.

Blocked control:

paitoh

Paitoh is blocked as comitative/accompany material. The analyzer tests treat it as lexicalized *go-accompany*, so the present grammar slice must not imply that every *-toh* token is upward-directional evidence. Upward *-toh* examples should therefore be paired with this explicit caveat.

Deuteronomy 32:50 also keeps nominalized *-toh-na* material visible:

-
- (3.46) *kàh-tòh-ná*
climb-up-NMLZ
'the mount whither thou goest up' / 'going up'

Kahtohna keeps *-toh-na* visible, but it is nominalized boundary material rather than a simple finite directional predicate.

Direction/side/manner -lam

Genesis 30:9 keeps *-lam* visible:

- (3.47) *tawp-lam*
end-TOWARD
'left off' / 'at the end' (Genesis 30:9)

Tawplam keeps *-lam* visible, but the export profile remains nominal (*tawp* / *N*). The safest present analysis is therefore direction/side/manner boundary material rather than a clean verbal directional suffix.

This row should not be used to turn every *-lam* form into a simple verbal directional.

Toward -sawn

Ezra 9:9 supplies the current cautious toward row:

- (3.48) *pía-sàwn*
give-toward
'give us' / 'extend to us'

Piasawn is the current cautious toward *-sawn* row. It is more useful than kinship-heavy or nominal-looking rows for this packet, but it still should stay construction-controlled. The current slice should not generalize from lexicalized, continuative-looking, or kinship-heavy *-sawn* material.

Downward -suk

Genesis 11:5 supplies the first corpus-backed downward row:

- (3.49) *pái-sùk*
go-DOWN
'came down'

Paisuk gives the packet a corpus-backed downward *-suk* row. Analyzer tests also support *-suk*, but print prose should rely on corpus-backed candidate rows rather than analyzer inventory alone.

Deferred forms: -lut, -phei, -cip, -tang

Several forms remain visible only as deferred or not print-ready controls in this first slice:

- *uilut* keeps *-lut* visible but is not yet a clean print-safe inward anchor;
- *paiphei* keeps *-phei* visible, but the current export gloss *go-enter* does not justify a clean horizontal claim;
- *cip* remains lexical or analyzer-noise material rather than directional down evidence;
- *tang* remains lexical or analyzer-noise material rather than endpoint-directional evidence.

These forms remain deferred or not print-ready in this slice. They should not be promoted without cleaner analyzer-backed corpus rows.

Editorial summary

This slice safely supports seven modest claims: *-khia* is usable as outward evidence, anchored by *pokhia*; *-khiat* is usable as away evidence, anchored by *nawhkhiat*, with *-khiat-na* boundary material from *hotkhiatna*; *-toh* is usable as upward evidence, anchored by *kilaktoh*, but only with the *paitoh* comitative/accompany caveat; *-toh-na* remains visible through *kahtohna* as nominalized boundary material; *-lam* remains direction/side/manner boundary material; *-sawn* remains cautious toward evidence through *piasawn*; and *-suk* is now corpus-backed downward evidence through *paisuk*.

What remains deferred is equally important: raw generated-report counts, raw suffix harvesting, *paitoh* as upward *-toh*, nominalized *-na* forms as equivalent to finite directional verbs, *-lut*, *-phei*, *-cip*, and *-tang* as print-ready directionals, and broad TAM or VP-slot prose. Broad TAM, chrestomathy, Mizo/lus, and other Kuki-Chin language work remain deferred.

The next step after this grammar slice is the dictionary print slice at `output/publication_review/dictionary_directional`. Dictionary and review-note work have not yet begun.

Derivation / valency

Source slice: `output/publication_review/grammar_derivation_valency_print_slice.md`

Editorial scope

This is the first narrow derivation / valency grammar slice for Tedim. It is controlled by `output/publication_review/candidate_derivation_valency_scope.md` and `output/publication_review/dossier_derivation_valency_scope.md`. Supporting/background evidence comes from `docs/grammar/reports/05-verb-08-derivational.md`, `docs/grammar/reports/05-verb-09-derivational.md`, `docs/grammar/morphemes/06-derivational.md`, `docs/grammar/lit-reviews/05-verb-09-valency-lit.md`, and the regression evidence in `tests/test_sak_caus_benf.py`.

This is not a full derivation chapter, not a full valency chapter, and not a full verbal morphology chapter. It also does not reopen adjacent packet domains already controlled through `output/publication_review/review_notes_vp_slots`, `output/publication_review/review_notes_tam.md`, `output/publication_review/review_notes_directional`, `output/publication_review/review_notes_pronouns.md`, `tests/test_vp_slots.py`, and `tests/test_prefix`.

The present slice therefore covers only the first safe *-sak* claim: *paisak* as the clearest causative anchor and *muhsak* as the clearest benefactive or applicative-like split row. No dictionary slice exists yet for derivation/valency, because the packet still leaves the *-sak* lexical split open for later editorial review.

Causative *-sak*

paisak is the safest causative anchor for the first print-facing derivation / valency claim. The candidate layer marks it as the main future *-sak* causative anchor, and `docs/grammar/reports/05-verb-09-valency.md` already lists it among the common *-sak* forms.

The safe grammar claim is deliberately narrow. The current evidence supports a productive Form I plus *-sak* causative pattern, with *paisak* as the candidate-controlled row that shows the pattern most cleanly. `tests/test_sak_caus_benf.py` protects that contrast explicitly by requiring *paisak* to gloss as *go-CAUS* rather than as a benefactive or lexicalized exception.

That is enough for the first core claim. The slice does not need to generalize over every *-sak* form in the reports before saying that a productive causative use is visible.

Benefactive / applicative-like *-sak*

muhsak is the safest benefactive or applicative-like split row in the current packet. The candidate layer keeps it distinct from the plain causative line, and `tests/test_sak_caus_benf.py` protects that distinction by requiring Form II plus *-sak* rows to keep the *.II* marker and a *BENF* gloss.

The print claim here also stays narrow. The current evidence supports keeping Form II plus *-sak* distinct from the plain causative line in the candidate layer, with *muhsak* as the clearest first-row anchor. The literature and morpheme files justify describing this as benefactive or applicative-like material, but the slice should not pretend that every higher-level label choice is already settled.

This is why *muhsak* belongs in the first slice even though it is more caveated than *paisak*. It is the clearest compact row showing that the *-sak* domain is not exhausted by a simple causative paraphrase.

Editorial treatment of the *-sak* split

The grammar can therefore treat the *paisak* versus *muhsak* contrast as a controlled split in the first print slice. The evidence is strong enough to keep Form I plus *-sak* and Form II plus *-sak* apart in the editorial layer.

At the same time, the slice should keep open the higher-level question of whether this contrast is best described as two readings of one suffix or two editorial subsections of the same suffixal domain. docs/grammar/lit-reviews/05-verb-09-valency-lit.md and docs/grammar/morphemes/06-derivational.md both support cautious wording here: the split is real enough for candidate control, but the final theoretical framing should stay smaller than a full chapter claim.

This first slice therefore adopts a practical editorial solution rather than a maximal theoretical one. It prints the causative and benefactive/applicative-like uses as separate controlled subsections while leaving open whether a later chapter should collapse them back into one suffix with two readings.

Boundary material

The rest of the candidate packet remains outside the first grammar slice because each row is still dominated by another unresolved boundary.

paipih stays outside the first grammar slice because *-pih* still carries applicative, comitative, associative, and benefactive uncertainty. *mipih* stays outside because it is nominal or lexicalized *pih* boundary material rather than a clean verbal anchor.

kisep and *kigen* stay outside because *ki-* still needs a separate reflexive, middle, and passive-like treatment, and because the packet must keep prefix/agreement boundary control explicit through output/publication_review/review_notes and tests/test_prefix_agr_poss.py.

ciahsakkik, *bawlsakthei*, and *paikhiatsak* stay outside because they are derivation-heavy stacks interacting respectively with aspect, modal, and directional material. Those rows remain visible through output/publication_review/review_notes_vp_structure_stacking.md, output/publication_review/review_notes_directionals.md, and tests/test_vp_slots.py, but they are not the first core derivation anchor.

piangsak stays outside because it is lexicalized or transitivity-adjacent rather than a clean productive *-sak* anchor.

Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest derivation / valency claim is that Tedim has candidate-controlled evidence for a productive *-sak* domain, with *paisak* supporting a causative use and *muhsak* supporting a distinct benefactive or applicative-like use.

That claim is deliberately smaller than a full derivation chapter, smaller than a full valency chapter, and smaller than a full verbal morphology chapter. It does not settle the whole *-pih* system, the whole *ki-* system, derivation-heavy stacking, or transitivity as a separate domain.

Recommended next step

After this grammar slice, the next step should be review notes rather than a dictionary layer, because a dictionary layer would risk overclaiming beyond the current candidate-controlled evidence before the *-sak* lexical split is reviewed.

Nominalization

Source slice: *output/publication_review/grammar_nominalization_print_slice.md*

Editorial scope

This is the first narrow nominalization grammar slice. It is controlled by *output/publication_review/candidates_nominalization_scope.md* and *output/publication_review/dossier_nominalization_scope.md*. Supporting/background evidence comes from *docs/grammar/reports/07-nmlz-01-deverbal.md*, *docs/grammar/morphemes/06-derivational_morphemes.md*, *docs/grammar/grammar_source_map.json*, and *docs/SKELETON_GRAMMAR.md*.

This is not a full nominalization chapter, not a full derivation chapter, not a full relative-clause chapter, and not a full case-routing chapter. It also stays narrow against *output/publication_review/candidates_clause_linkage.tsv*, *output/publication_review/review_notes_clause_linkage.md*, *output/publication_review/review_notes_derivation_valency.md*, *output/publication_review/review_notes_pronouns.md*, and *output/publication_review/review_notes_pronouns.md*.

The present slice therefore covers only the first safe nominalization claim. *-na* is the clearest productive deverbal nominalizer, with *bawl-na* as the controlled anchor form, *bawl-na* as the segmentation, and *make-NMLZ / making, creation* as the controlled gloss and function. No dictionary slice exists yet for nominalization, because this packet is still establishing a controlled constructional or morphological claim rather than a settled lexical layer. The packet now properly proceeds through nominalization review notes rather than a dictionary slice.

Deverbal nominalization with *-na*

-na is the safest current nominalization anchor in the packet. The candidate TSV marks it as the main future print-facing row, and the report, source map, and skeleton all converge on it as the primary productive deverbal nominalizer.

The grammar claim here is deliberately limited. At the current slice maturity level, the safe print-facing row is *bawl-na*, with the segmentation *bawl-na* and the controlled gloss *make-NMLZ / making, creation*. That is enough to support a narrow claim for productive deverbal action or result nominalization without broadening into a full nominalization chapter.

Why *-pa* and *-mi* are not yet the first slice

Agentive or person-head nominalization evidence also exists in the candidate layer, especially through *bawlpa* and *hong pai mi*.

Those rows stay outside the first print-facing claim because *-pa* has lexicalized or title-like boundary rows such as *kumpipa* and *Topa*, while *-mi* still overlaps with person-head and relative-clause analysis. The packet is stronger if it keeps *-pa* and *-mi* visible but secondary rather than forcing them into the first nominalization slice before those lexical and clausal boundaries are better settled.

Why nominalized relatives are not yet the first slice

Nominalized relative or clause-derived nominal evidence also exists in the candidate layer, especially through *omna*.

That row stays outside the first print-facing claim because it still belongs partly to clause linkage and relative-clause analysis. The current packet can safely preserve *omna* as candidate-layer evidence without pretending that the first nominalization slice should already resolve the nominalization versus relative-clause boundary.

Why nominalization plus case is not yet the first slice

Nominalization-plus-case evidence also exists in the boundary layer, especially through *muhna-ah*.

That row stays outside the first print-facing claim because it belongs partly to case marking and clause-linkage boundaries. It is important evidence for later packet coordination, but it should not lead the first nominalization slice.

Boundary material

The rest of the nominalization packet stays outside the first grammar slice because each row is still dominated by another unresolved boundary.

bawlpā stays outside because agentive *-pā* still has to be separated from lexicalized and title-like rows.

hong pai mi stays outside because person-head *-mi* still overlaps with relative-clause analysis.

omna stays outside because nominalized relatives remain shared with clause linkage.

muhna-ah stays outside because nominalization plus case routing remains shared with case marking.

kumpipa and *Topa* stay outside because lexicalized or title-like *-pā* rows should not be mistaken for the cleanest productive anchor.

a bawl mi and similar human-head relative rows stay outside because they still sit between nominalization, relative clauses, and prefix/agreement questions.

bare *na* stays outside because it is an analyzer-noisy surface form.

report-only counts stay outside because attestation by itself does not make a row safe for the first print-facing claim.

Any broad nominalization chapter claim stays outside because this packet is not yet ready to generalize from one safe deverbal nominalizer to the whole nominalization system.

Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest nominalization claim is that Tedim has candidate-controlled evidence for productive deverbal nominalization with *-na*, with *bawlna* / *bawl-na* as the clearest current anchor. Agentive *-pā*, person-head *-mi*, nominalized relatives, and nominalization-plus-case rows remain candidate-layer or boundary material.

That claim is deliberately smaller than a full nominalization chapter, smaller than a full derivation chapter, smaller than a full relative-clause chapter, and smaller than a full case-routing chapter.

Recommended next step

This packet now properly proceeds to nominalization review notes rather than to a dictionary slice, because this is a constructional or morphological packet and the lexical treatment of *-pā*, *-mi*, and lexicalized forms remains unsettled.

If the project later wants more nominalization work after review notes, the next sub-scope should be a separate *-pā* or *-mi* agentive candidate expansion rather than a dictionary layer, but not in this commit.

Clause linkage

Source slice: `output/publication_review/grammar_clause_linkage_print_slice.md`

Editorial scope

This is the first narrow clause-linkage grammar slice for Tedim. It is controlled by `output/publication_review/candidate` and `output/publication_review/dossier_clause_linkage_scope.md`. Supporting/background evidence comes from `docs/grammar/reports/08-clause-01-subordination.md`, `docs/grammar/reports/08-clause-02-clause-linkage.md`, `docs/grammar/reports/08-clause-03-relatives.md`, and `docs/grammar/lit-reviews/08-clause-03-subordi`

This is not a full complex-sentence chapter, not a full switch-reference chapter, and not a full relative-clause chapter. It also stays narrow against output/publication_review/review_notes_sentence_final_particles.md, output/publication_review/review_notes_tam.md, output/publication_review/review_notes_vp_structu, output/publication_review/review_notes_prefix_agreement.md, and output/publication_review/review_

The present slice therefore covers only the first safe subordination claim. *Ciangin* is the clearest temporal subordination anchor, while *dingin* remains visible only as a caveated purposive or clause-bound irrealis overlap row. No dictionary slice exists yet for clause linkage, because this packet is still establishing a controlled clausal claim rather than a lexical headword layer. The packet now properly proceeds through clause-linkage review notes rather than a dictionary slice.

Temporal subordination: ciangin

Ciangin is the safest current subordination anchor in the packet. The candidate TSV marks it as the main future print-facing row, and the reports plus literature review converge on it as the clearest temporal subordinator.

The grammar claim here is deliberately limited. At the current slice maturity level, the safe print-facing row is *tua ciangin*, with the segmentation *ciang-in* kept visible where useful. That is enough to support a narrow temporal subordination claim without broadening into a full complex-sentence chapter or a full inventory of all clause-linkage constructions.

Clause-bound purposive / irrealis overlap: dingin

Dingin is relevant to clause linkage because the reports support purposive or clause-bound irrealis use, but it remains partly shared with TAM. The candidate layer is therefore right to keep it explicit while refusing to let it lead the first slice.

The grammar claim stays cautious on purpose. At the current slice maturity level, *dingin* is visible only as a caveated overlap row: it helps show that clause linkage interacts with purposive or irrealis marking, but it does not yet justify a broader clause-linkage or TAM rewrite.

Why switch reference is not yet the first slice

Switch-reference evidence exists in the candidate layer, especially through *VERB-in* with *ngenin* as the anchor example and through *ahih ciangin* as the clearest different-subject construction.

Those rows stay outside the first print-facing claim because the converb, subordinator, and switch-reference analysis remains theoretically unsettled. The current packet can safely preserve them as candidate-layer evidence without pretending that the first clause-linkage slice should already be a switch-reference chapter.

Why relative clauses are not yet the first slice

Relative-clause evidence also exists in the candidate layer, especially through *a bawl mi* and *omna*.

Those rows stay outside the first print-facing claim because relative clauses still interact with prefix/agreement, nominalization, and case-routing questions. The packet is stronger if it keeps relative clauses visible but secondary rather than forcing them into the first clause-linkage slice before those boundaries are better settled.

Boundary material

The rest of the clause-linkage packet stays outside the first grammar slice because each row is still dominated by another unresolved boundary.

VERB-in and *ngenin* stay outside because same-subject chaining still sits on the boundary between converbial chaining, subordination, and switch-reference analysis.

ahih ciangin stays outside because different-subject linkage still overlaps with temporal subordination and pronominal boundary questions.

a bawl mi and *omna* stay outside because relative clauses still interact with prefix/agreement and nominalization. *muhna-ah* stays outside because nominalized relative-plus-case material belongs to a later nominalization and case-routing treatment.

leh stays outside because sentence-final-particle, coordinator, and subordinator analyses still overlap there.

hangin and *bangin* stay outside because they remain broader report-inventory rows rather than the first safe print anchor.

report-only relative-clause counts involving *a-* also stay outside because they do not yet separate relativizer behavior cleanly from broader prefix/agreement material.

Any broad complex-sentence chapter claim stays outside because this packet is not yet ready to generalize from one safe subordination anchor to the whole clause-linkage system.

Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest clause-linkage claim is that Tedim has candidate-controlled evidence for temporal subordination, with *ciangin* as the clearest current anchor. *Dingin* is visible as a caveated purposive or clause-bound irrealis overlap row, but switch reference and relative clauses remain candidate-layer material.

That claim is deliberately smaller than a full complex-sentence chapter, smaller than a full switch-reference chapter, and smaller than a full relative-clause chapter.

Recommended next step

This packet now properly proceeds to clause-linkage review notes rather than to a dictionary slice, because it is a constructional or clausal packet rather than a lexical-headword packet.

If the project later wants one more clause-linkage step before review notes and human review, the next sub-scope should be a separate switch-reference or relative-clause candidate expansion rather than a dictionary layer, but not in this commit.

Clause type, discourse-facing material, and expressive morphology

Negation

Source slice: `output/publication_review/grammar_negation_print_slice.md`

Scope

This account offers a short treatment of Tedim negation. It is intentionally narrow. It focuses on a small set of manually checked Bible examples and on the interaction between *lo*, *loh*, and *kei*. It does not attempt a full TAM chapter, a treatment of directionals, or a complete account of every negative construction in the corpus.

Overview of the negation system

The literature and the Bible corpus agree on one central point: Tedim negation cannot be reduced to *lo* alone. Henderson foregrounds *-kei*, including prohibitive uses, while Zam Ngaih Cing explicitly describes a contrast between *-kei* and *-lou/-louh* and links the latter to stem-sensitive or dependent environments (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017). The safest summary is therefore not “Tedim negation = *lo*”, but rather that the present corpus supports a three-part treatment: ordinary clause-level negation with *lo*, dependent or derived negation with *loh*, and *kei* as a central negator in prohibitives and many irrealis-heavy or directive contexts.

Clause-level negation with *lo*

Lo is the safest place to start because it is the clearest ordinary clause-level negator in the Bible corpus. It appears in straightforward negative predicates such as *thusim lo hi*, *nei lo hi*, *om lo hi*, and in many future or

modal combinations such as *V lo ding*. That does not make it the whole negation system, but it does make it the most transparent starting point.

- (4.50) *àhìh hàng-ìn Kain lè àmà piak-ná thusim lò hì. Túa àhìh*
 be.3SG.REL because-ERG KAIN and 3SG.POSS give.to-NMLZ parable NEG DECL DIST be.3SG.REL
ciang-ìn Kain hèh màhmàh à, à mái sía hì.
 then-ERG KAIN anger very 3SG 3SG face evil DECL
 'but unto Cain and to his offering he had not respect. And Cain was very wroth, and his countenance fell.' (Genesis 4:5)

Genesis 4:5 is a good central example because it shows exactly the clause type a reader expects from a first negation section: a verbal predicate followed by *lo* and the clause-final declarative material. Genesis 11:30 *ta nei lo hi* is equally useful in a more compact predicative clause, and existential patterns such as *om lo hi* belong in the same zone.

V lo uh is a real and common surface string, but it is not automatically prohibitive. Genesis 2:25 *maizum lo uh hi* means "they were not ashamed" and is simply an ordinary plural negative predicate. Similar plural negatives occur elsewhere with no imperative force. It is better treated as an ordinary clausal negative pattern than as the defining prohibitive construction.

Dependent and derived negation with *loh*

Loh should not be treated as a random spelling variant of *lo*. In the current Bible corpus it clusters in dependent, purposive, and derived environments such as ... *loh dinga*, ... *loh dingin*, and ... *loh nadingin*. The safest label is therefore something like "dependent or derived negative form", not just "another way to spell *lo*".

- (4.51) *Àmàh ìn, nà guak-tāng-à nà òm-ná kua ìn hòng gēn àhì hiam? Nà*
 3SG.PRO ERG 2SG bare-body-LOC 2SG exist-NMLZ who ERG 3→1 speak be.3SG Q 2SG
nèk lòh òng-à kòng thupiak singgah né khá nà hì hiam cí
 eat.II NEG-NOM IRR-LOC 1SG→3 commandment hang eat NEG.PERF 2SG DECL Q say
hì.
 DECL

'And he said, Who told thee that thou wast naked? Hast thou eaten of the tree, whereof I commanded thee that thou shouldest not eat?' (Genesis 3:11)

Genesis 3:11 is especially useful because *loh* is not just attached to a bare verb in isolation. It appears inside a dependent complex, *na nek loh dinga kong thupiak*, where the whole point is the commanded non-occurrence of the event. Isaiah 6:10 strengthens the same pattern by repeating *muh loh nading*, *zak loh nading*, and *theihtel loh nading* inside clearly purposive or clause-linking material. This is exactly the distribution seen again and again in the corpus: *loh* is where the Bible orthography most visibly tracks non-finite, dependent, and derived negation.

kei in prohibitives and irrealis-heavy negation

Kei is central to real prohibitives in the Bible corpus, and those prohibitives are among the cleanest manually checked negative examples available. This alone is enough to show why the negation system cannot be flattened to *lo*.

- (4.52) *Àmàh ìn, tangval-pà sù kèi ìn. Àmà tòngàh bangmah hìh kèi ìn. Bàng*
 3SG.PRO ERG TANGVALPA tear NEG ERG 3SG.POSS on-LOC nothing PROX NEG ERG like
hàng hiam cìh lèh nàng ìn Pasion nà zah-tàk-ná tù-ìn kà théi à,
 reason Q say.NOM and 2SG.PRO ERG God 2SG fear-exact-NMLZ now-ERG 1SG know 3SG

nà tá-pà khàt nèih-sun kèima à dīng-ìn nà hum-cìp lòh-ná kà mú
 2SG child-male one have.II-long 1SG.self 3SG IRR-ERG 2SG fear-grip NEG-NMLZ 1SG see.I
hì à cí hì.
 DECL 3SG say DECL

'And he said, Lay not thine hand upon the lad, neither do thou any thing unto him: for now I know that thou fearest God, seeing thou hast not withheld thy son, thine only son from me.' (Genesis 22:12)

Genesis 22:12 gives two clear negative imperatives in the same speech turn. Genesis 15:1 *Lau kei in*, Genesis 19:17 *Nunghei kei unla*, ... *khawl kei un*, Leviticus 10:9 *ne kei un*, and Numbers 14:42 *kuanto kei un ... do kei un* all point in the same direction: *kei* is the core prohibitive negator in the current Bible data.

The corpus also shows that *kei* is not limited to prohibitives or to first-person realis. Exodus 5:2 has both *ka thei kei hi* and *ka paisak kei dīng hi*, which shows *kei* in ordinary negation and in irrealis-heavy future material. The safest print summary is therefore that *kei* is central in prohibitives and common in directive, quoted, or otherwise irrealis-heavy negation, without forcing the whole system into a rigid person-based rule.

Negative existence and cessative negation

Negative existence belongs with ordinary *lo*-based negation, but it deserves its own short section because it is extremely common and very readable in Bible prose. Clauses such as Genesis 11:30 *ta nei lo hi*, Genesis 37:24 *a sungah tui om lo hi*, and Genesis 39:9 *a kep tuam bangmah om lo hi* show the ordinary Tedim way of saying that something is absent, unavailable, or not possessed.

The corpus also supports a neat constructional entry for *nawn lo* "no longer, not again". Genesis 8:12 *hong ciahkik nawn lo hi* is a clean cessative example, and Genesis 17:5 *Na min Abram hi nawn lo dīng a* shows the same construction in a renamed-future environment. This material is better treated as a construction than as a new basic negator.

Ability and inability

The clearest treatment here is not a bare negator but the constructional pair *thei lo* / *theih loh*. The Bible shows common clause-level inability with *thei lo*, while dependent or derived negative ability is better represented by *theih loh* patterns than by the much rarer exact string *theih lo*.

(4.53) *À khùt-tè ìn à sanggampa Esau' khùt bàng-ìn múl néi àhìh mán-ìn*
 3SG hand-PL ERG 3SG brother ESAU.POSS hand like-ERG hair have be.3SG.REL reason-ERG
àmàh ìn thei lò hì. Túa àhìh cìang-ìn ààmàh ìn thù-phà pía
 3SG.PRO ERG know NEG DECL DIST be.3SG.REL then-ERG 3SG.PRO ERG word-good give
dīng-ìn kithawi à,
 IRR-ERG hot.displeasure 3SG

'And he discerned him not, because his hands were hairy, as his brother Esau's hands: so he blessed him.' (Genesis 27:23)

Genesis 27:23 is a compact ordinary example: *thei lo hi* means that recognition or knowledge failed to occur. Genesis 37:4 *amah hopih thei lo uh hi* shows the same pattern with an ability reading, while Exodus 33:20 *na mu thei kei dīng hi* shows inability under *kei*. On the dependent side, Exodus 10:5 *muh theih loh nadingin* and Isaiah 6:10 *theihtel loh nading* show why *theih loh* must be represented directly rather than treating exact *theih lo* as the dominant form in the current corpus.

Negative polarity items

The Bible corpus gives clean negative-polarity material, but only after filtering. Raw exact-string counts overgenerate because *kuamah* can occur in non-pronominal strings and *bangmah* has non-NPI uses such as *tua bangmah hi-in* "likewise". The discussion here therefore uses only manually checked examples.

(4.54) *Àmàh khù-a-dāk kawī-kawī à, kuamah mú lò àhìh mán-in Egypt*
 3SG.PRO town-near crooked~REDUP 3SG nobody see.I NEG be.3SG.REL reason-ERG EGYPT
mipa thàt-in sehnēl sùng-àh à seel hì.
 man kill-CVB wilderness inside-LOC 3SG hide DECL

'And he looked this way and that way, and when he saw that there was no man, he slew the Egyptian, and hid him in the sand.' (Exodus 2:12)

Exodus 2:12 is a good *kuamah* example because the NPI is clearly licensed by the negative predicate. *Bangmah* behaves similarly in real NPI contexts such as Genesis 22:12 *Ama tungah bangmah hih kei in* and Genesis 39:9 *bangmah om lo hi*. Those are the kinds of examples the dictionary can safely quote. What should stay out of the main prose is any claim based on raw counts alone.

Summary

The current evidence is strong enough for a stable negation chapter, but only if it keeps the system narrow and honest. *Lo* is the safest starting point for ordinary clause-level negation. *Loh* is a real dependent or derived negative form and should not be collapsed into accidental spelling variation. *Kei* is central in prohibitives and in many irrealis-heavy negatives, so the chapter must represent it directly rather than relegating it to a footnote.

Just as important, the description must avoid false simplicity. *V lo uh* is not the prohibitive construction, Genesis 2:25 is not a prohibitive example, and the NPI section must use filtered examples rather than raw exact-string totals. The result is a compact but linguistically honest account of the current Bible evidence.

Interrogatives

Source slice: *output/publication_review/grammar_interrogatives_print_slice.md*

Scope

This short print-facing draft section on interrogatives in Tedim Chin is controlled by *candidates_interrogatives.tsv* and *dossier_interrogatives.md*. It covers clause-final *hiam* and selected WH + *hiam* content questions. It does not yet attempt a full treatment of the sentence-final particle system, and it leaves comparison particles such as *maw*, *ham*, and *em* for later review.

Interrogatives in outline

The current candidate-backed packet supports a narrow generalization. Yes/no questions can be marked by clause-final *hiam*, and content questions use a WH element plus *hiam*. The present WH inventory represented in the packet is *bang*, *kua*, *bangci*, and *banghangin*. Embedded question complements are visible in the dossier, but they are not yet ready for the first printed analysis.

Because this slice is controlled by the candidate-first packet rather than by raw report counts, it should stay narrow. The point here is not to describe every sentence-final question marker or every surface occurrence of *hiam*, but to print only the examples that the current candidate and dossier layer already support.

Clause-final *hiam*

The current candidate-backed examples support clause-final *hiam* as the core yes/no pattern represented in this packet. The best print anchor is Genesis 24:23, using the attested analyzer-backed clause rather than the older generated-report paraphrase.

(4.55) *Nà pà inn-àh kòtè giah nàding à áwng dīng hiam*
 2SG father house-LOC 1PL.PRO camp PURP 3SG open IRR Q

'Is there room in thy father's house for us to lodge?'

This printed example should replace the older report paraphrase *Inn-ah hong tum theih na hiam*. The dossier is explicit that the exported window for Genesis 24:23 is *Na pa inn-ah kote giah nading a awng ding hiam*, and that attested clause is what the print slice should use. The candidate TSV also records one export caveat: punctuation is attached to the final token in the raw analyzer window, but that punctuation artifact should not be printed as if it were part of *hiam* itself.

WH + *hiam* content questions

The content-question pattern in the current packet is WH + *hiam*. The safest print-facing claim is therefore not that every WH form behaves identically, but that the present candidate-backed examples show *bang*, *kua*, *bangci*, and *banghangin* in this construction.

- (4.56) *Bàng àhì hiam?*
like be.3SG Q
'What is it?'

Exodus 16:15 is the current print anchor for *bang*. The dossier keeps one export caveat explicit: the analyzer glosses *bang* here as *like*. The clause-level evidence and KJV alignment still support the ordinary what-question reading, so the example remains usable in print with that caveat recorded in the packet rather than foregrounded in the example line.

- (4.57) *Hih-tè kua àhì hiam?*
PROX-PL who be.3SG Q
'Who are these?'

Genesis 48:8 is the current print anchor for *kua ... hiam*, and 2 Samuel 22:32 gives additional support for the same pattern (*Topa longal Pasian kua hiam*). The dossier again keeps the relevant export caveat explicit: *kua* is tagged as *NUM* in the analyzer output. That label should be treated as an export limitation rather than as evidence against the interrogative reading.

- (4.58) *Bangci à hi-cí gàm-tat nà hì hiam?*
how 3SG PROX-say land-rule 2SG DECL Q
'How have you acted thus?' (Genesis 3:13)

Genesis 3:13 is the cleanest current *bangci* row, and it matters methodologically because it should remain visible as *bangci*, not be flattened into a generic *bang* example.

The present packet also keeps Genesis 4:6 as reason-question evidence:

bang hangin na mai sia ahi hiam

This row is important because it keeps *banghangin* in the slice while also recording the segmentation caveat from the dossier. The analyzer exports the sequence as *bang | hang-in | na | mai | sia | ahi | hiam*, but the current packet still treats the clause as curated reason-question evidence rather than as a raw *bang* hit.

Embedded questions

The dossier keeps Exodus 16:15 *bang hiam cih thei lo uh hi* visible as embedded-question material, but it is not promoted here as a core independent-clause *hiam* example. It should remain deferred for a later treatment of embedded questions or interrogative complementation, not folded into the first printed outline as if it were interchangeable with the main clause-final examples above.

Blocked false friends

The packet also shows why raw *hiam* and *bang* matching would overgenerate. *Bang hang hiam cih leh* in Genesis 3:20 is a formulaic explanatory frame, not an ordinary question example. Revelation 1:16 *langnih a hiam namsau*

and 2 Kings 11:11 a *hiam ciat uh* are lexical or non-interrogative *hiam* controls rather than question-particle evidence. Likewise, *bangmah* and *bangin* are bang-family false friends and should not be treated as ordinary *bang* interrogatives.

These blocked rows matter because they keep the printed claim small and accurate: the slice prints candidate-backed interrogative examples, not every surface string that happens to contain *hiam* or *bang*.

Deferred particles

Existing generated reports mention *maw*, *ham*, and *em*, but they remain deferred in this first print slice. They are not part of the core *hiam* evidence printed here, and this section does not yet build a comparison-particle analysis.

Editorial summary

This slice can now safely support four modest claims. First, *hiam* is the candidate-backed question marker in the current print packet, with clause-final *hiam* as the core pattern represented in the accepted examples. Second, WH + *hiam* is the current content-question pattern. Third, *bang*, *kua*, *bangci*, and *banghangin* are the current candidate-backed WH forms. Fourth, embedded questions and deferred comparison particles remain outside the scope of this first printed analysis.

Sentence-final particles

Source slice: `output/publication_review/grammar_sentence_final_particles_print_slice.md`

Scope

This is a short print-facing draft section on sentence-final particles in Tedim Chin, controlled by `candidates_sentence_final` and `dossier_sentence_final_particles.md`.

It covers only a small candidate-backed set: caveated declarative evidence with *ahi hi*; caveated negative-plus-declarative evidence with *thusim lo hi*; optative *hen* in *Khuavak om hen*; singular imperative *in* in *teembaw khat bawl in*, with case-marker overlap caveat; and plural imperative *un* in *gingsak un*, currently the cleanest imperative anchor.

It does not yet attempt a full sentence-final particle system, a full mood or aspect chapter, a full TAM account, a new treatment of *hiam*, a settled analysis of *tahen*, *aw*, *ta*, or *zo*, or generated-report frequency tables. Dictionary and review-note slices have not yet begun.

Sentence-final particles in outline

The current candidate-backed packet supports a narrow generalization. *Hi* is visible only through constructionally controlled *ahi hi* and *lo hi* rows. *Hiam* is visible only as overlap control because interrogatives are already stabilized. *Hen* has one usable optative row. *In* and *un* represent imperative material, but *in* has case-marker overlap while *un* is cleaner. *Aw* is only vocative or exclamative boundary material and is not print-ready. *Tahen*, *ta*, and *zo* remain deferred or needs-review because the export is noisy. Broad TAM remains deferred.

Declarative *hi* with copula overlap

Genesis 1:13 supplies the current declarative anchor:

(4.59) *àhì* *hì*
 be.3SG DECL
 'it was'

This is the current copula-plus-declarative evidence, but only with caveat. It is not a bare *hi* example. The row bundles copular *ahi* with final *hi*, so it does not license raw *hi* harvesting or a claim that every *hi* token is sentence-final declarative.

Negative-plus-declarative *lo hi*

Genesis 4:5 keeps one negative-plus-declarative environment visible:

- (4.60) *thusim lò hi*
parable NEG DECL
'he had not respect' / 'it was not accepted' (Genesis 4:5)

This row keeps *lo hi* visible as a sentence-final environment, but it overlaps the stabilized negation packet. The present slice should not reopen *lo* or build a new negation section here. It is treated as negation-overlap evidence only.

Hiam as interrogatives overlap

Deferred / overlap control:

Hihte kua ahi hiam?

Genesis 48:8 is mentioned here only as cross-reference material. *Hiam* belongs to the stabilized interrogatives packet, so this sentence-final particle slice should not reopen or duplicate *hiam* analysis. The row is not a print anchor for this slice, and the quotation or punctuation noise plus the *kua* = *NUM* export caveat should remain visible rather than normalized away.

Optative *hen*

Genesis 1:3 supplies the current usable optative row:

- (4.61) *Khuavak òm hèn*
light exist JUSS
'Let there be light' (Genesis 1:3)

This is the current usable optative evidence with caveat. The candidate is analyzer-backed as *om hen*, so the slice should not replace it with report-style *ta hen* wording. It also should not turn this narrow row into a broad mood chapter.

Imperative *in* and *un*

Genesis 6:14 keeps one singular imperative row visible:

- (4.62) *teembaw khàt bāwl in*
ark one make ERG
'Make thee an ark' (Genesis 6:14)

This keeps singular imperative *in* visible, but only with a serious case-marker and export caveat: *in* is exported as *ERG* / *FUNC*. The candidate also has *teembaw*, not report-style *lawng*. The slice should not harvest raw *in* hits and should not reopen case marking.

Psalms 100:1 supplies the cleanest current imperative anchor:

- (4.63) *ging-sàk ùn*
sound-CAUS IMP.PL
'Make a joyful noise'

This is the clean plural-imperative anchor. The span should stay tight so nearby *aw* material in the same verse is not absorbed, and the row should not be used to launch a full imperative paradigm.

***Aw* as vocative/exclamative boundary material**

Boundary material:

Gam khempeuh aw

Psalms 100:1 keeps *aw* visible, but only as vocative or exclamative boundary material. The analyzer glosses *aw* as *voice* and gives *N* in *pos_span*, and the same verse also has another *aw* in *lungdamna aw*. This is therefore not settled sentence-final mood evidence, and raw *aw* hits should not be treated as sentence-final particles.

***Tahen, ta, and zo* deferred**

Several report-visible rows remain too noisy to promote:

- *hi taken*: deferred because *tahen* is exported as *army / N*; the slice should not normalize fused *tahen* or split *ta hen* into a clean jussive example.
- *mangngilh ta hi*: needs-review TAM-overlap material because *ta* is exported as *child / FUNC*.
- *zo*: deferred because the export glosses *zo* as *south / N* rather than as clean completive evidence.

These rows keep report-visible material in view, but they are not print-ready as jussive, perfective, or completive evidence. Broad TAM remains deferred.

Editorial summary

This slice safely supports five modest claims: *ahi hi* is usable as copula-plus-declarative evidence with caveat; *thusim lo hi* is usable as negation-plus-declarative evidence with caveat; *Khuavak om hen* is usable as optative evidence with caveat; *teembaw khat bawl in* is usable as singular imperative evidence only with a case-overlap caveat; and *gingsak un* is the clean plural-imperative anchor.

What remains deferred is equally important: bare *hi* as a general declarative particle, *hiam* as new sentence-final evidence, *tahen* as a settled jussive, *aw* as a settled exclamative or mood particle, *ta* and *zo* as settled aspectual particles, broad TAM and full mood or aspect chapters, and raw generated-report counts. Broad TAM, directionals, chrestomathy, Mizo/lus, and other Kuki-Chin language work remain deferred.

The next step after this grammar slice is the dictionary print slice at `output/publication_review/dictionary_sentence`. Dictionary and review-note slices have not yet begun.

Coordinators

Source slice: `output/publication_review/grammar_coordinators_print_slice.md`

Scope

This is a short print-facing draft section on coordinators in Tedim Chin, controlled by `candidates_coordinators.tsv` and `dossier_coordinators.md`.

It covers only a small candidate-backed set: NP coordination with *le*, anchored by Genesis 1:1 *vantung le leitung*; conditional or boundary *leh*, not clean clause-conjunction *leh*; sequential *a* only as caveated boundary material, paired with a blocked agreement-*a* false friend; *mawh* only as deferred lexical or analyzer-noise material; *Ahih hangin* as a caveated adversative connector; and *ahih kei leh* as conditional-adversative boundary material.

It does not yet attempt a full coordination system, a full clause-linking or converb system, a full temporal or causal subordinator treatment, a full sentence-final particle treatment, or generated-report frequency tables. Dictionary and review-note slices have not yet begun.

Coordinators in outline

The current candidate-backed packet supports a narrow generalization. *Le* currently provides the safe NP-conjunction anchor. *Leh* is visible, but only as conditional or boundary evidence rather than as print-ready simple clause conjunction. *A* is visible only as caveated sequential-linkage boundary evidence and must not

be harvested raw. *Mawh* remains deferred until a clean disjunction or alternative-question example is located. *Ahih hangin* is the current adversative connector anchor, with an internal-analysis caveat. *Ahih kei leh* is conditional-adversative boundary material, not a simple coordinator.

NP coordination with *le*

Genesis 1:1 supplies the clean print-ready anchor:

- (4.64) *vàn-tùng lè léi-tùng*
 sky-on and land-on
 'heaven and earth'

This is the current safe NP-conjunction anchor. It supports a modest print claim that *le* joins noun phrases.

That claim must remain narrow. The row does **not** license broad raw *le* harvesting, and the current packet does not treat every *le* token as coordinator evidence. A separate blocked *le* row was not created in the first pass; overgeneration is controlled here by curated selection rather than by a broad token sweep.

Leh as conditional or boundary material

Genesis 13:9 keeps *leh* visible only as warning or boundary evidence:

- (4.65) *véi-lam nà lāk lèh kèi taklam-àh kà pái dīng hì*
 faint-direction 2SG among and NEG right-LOC 1SG go IRR DECL
 'if thou wilt take the left hand, then I will go to the right' (Genesis 13:9)

This row keeps *leh* visible, but not as a clean simple clause-conjunction anchor. The wider English context is conditional, so future coordinator prose must not flatten conditional *leh* into a simple printed “and” analysis.

The row also carries an analyzer or export caveat: *kei* is glossed as *NEG* in the selected window even though the wider English context is “I will go.” That should be recorded as an export caveat, not used to reopen the pronouns or negation packets.

Sequential *a* and agreement-*a* false friends

Genesis 2:10 keeps one possible sequential-linkage window visible:

- (4.66) *luang à túa mún pàn-in gun hòng kikhen-in*
 flow 3SG DIST place ABL-ERG river 3→1 separate-CVB
 'and from thence it was parted' (Genesis 2:10)

This row keeps possible sequential linkage visible, but it is not print-ready as a core coordinator example. The analyzer still exports the relevant *a* as *3SG / FUNC*, so the present slice treats it as warning or boundary evidence only.

Blocked control:

a piangsak

Genesis 1:1 *a piangsak* is blocked agreement or function material, not coordinator evidence. This false-friend control prevents raw *a* harvesting from flooding the coordinator packet.

Mawh deferred

The present slice does not print a positive *mawh* example.

Deferred control:

mawh

The generated report mentions *mawh* as disjunction or alternative-question material, but the current candidate layer only has Genesis 6:3, where *mawh* is lexical or analyzer-noise material glossed as *sin / V* rather than as disjunction. *Mawh* therefore remains not print-ready in this slice.

Report-only schematic examples such as *mi mawh ganhing mawh* or *pai ding mawh om ding mawh* should not be printed unless a later analyzer-backed row is actually located.

Adversative *Ahih hangin*

Genesis 3:4 supplies the current adversative connector anchor:

(4.67) *Àhih* *hàng-in*
 be.3SG.REL because-ERG
 'but'

This row is usable with caveat as the current adversative connector. It remains internally analyzable as *ahih* + *hang-in*, so the present slice should not open a full causal or subordinator analysis from this row.

Conditional-adversative *ahih kei leh*

Exodus 12:3 keeps one compact boundary row visible:

(4.68) *àhih* *kèi* *lèh*
 be.3SG.REL NEG and
 'otherwise' / 'if not'

This row is useful as conditional-adversative boundary material, but it is not a simple coordinator. It overlaps with negation and conditional *leh*, yet the slice should not reopen the stabilized negation packet.

Deferred material

Several limits remain important at this stage:

- clean simple clause-conjunction *leh* remains deferred;
- clean *mawh* disjunction or alternative-question evidence remains deferred;
- full sequential-*a* analysis remains deferred;
- *ciangin* and broader *hangin* temporal or causal subordinator material remain deferred;
- full clause-chaining or converb coordination remains deferred;
- sentence-final particles remain outside the scope of this slice;
- generated-report raw counts remain excluded.

Broad TAM, directionals, chrestomathy, Mizo/lus, and other Kuki-Chin language work likewise remain deferred.

Editorial summary

This slice now safely supports four modest claims: *le* is the current NP conjunction anchor, anchored by *vantung le Leitung*; *Ahih hangin* is usable as an adversative connector with caveat; *ahih kei leh* is useful as conditional-adversative boundary evidence with caveat; and *leh*, *a*, plus *mawh* remain visible only as warning, deferred, or boundary material.

What remains deferred is equally important: raw frequency counts, treating every *le*, *leh*, or *a* token as coordinator evidence, simple clause-conjunction *leh*, *mawh* as accepted disjunction, a full sequential-*a* analysis, a fuller temporal or causal subordinator treatment, and sentence-final particles. The next step after this grammar slice is the dictionary print slice, while dictionary and review-note work have not yet begun.

Reduplication

Source slice: *output/publication_review/grammar_reduplication_print_slice.md*

Editorial scope

This is the first narrow reduplication grammar slice. It is controlled by *output/publication_review/candidates_reduplication_scope.md* and *output/publication_review/dossier_reduplication_scope.md*. Supporting/background evidence comes from *docs/grammar/reports/07-deriv-02-reduplication.md*.

This is not a full derivation chapter, not a full reduplication chapter, not a dictionary slice, and not a TAM/aspect or VP-structure slice. It also stays narrow against *output/publication_review/review_notes_derivation_valency.md*, *output/publication_review/review_notes_nominalization.md*, *output/publication_review/review_notes_noun_domain.md*, and *output/publication_review/review_notes_verb_domain.md*.

The present slice therefore covers only the first safe full-reduplication claim. No dictionary slice exists for reduplication, because this packet is grammar-facing and constructional rather than lexical.

Full reduplication as intensification

mahmah is the main full-reduplication intensifier anchor.

The controlled segmentation and gloss/function are *mah~mah* and *EMPH~EMPH* / *very, truly*.

The report also supports the worked example *pha mahmah hi*, glossed there as *good very DECL*.

taktak is the closest support row for the same small intensifying pattern.

Its controlled segmentation and gloss/function are *tak~tak* and *TRUE~TRUE* / *truly, certainly*.

Taken together, *mahmah* and *taktak* support a narrow full-reduplication intensifier pattern, not the whole reduplication system.

Secondary distributive evidence

peuhpeuh remains visible as secondary distributive evidence for full reduplication.

Its controlled segmentation and gloss/function are *peuh~peuh* and *each~each* / *every, each*.

It stays outside the leading claim because it is more quantifier-like or noun-modifying than the clean intensifier anchors.

Boundary material

ni ni stays outside the first grammar slice because syntactic X X repetition overlaps with temporal/adverbial and VP-structure interpretation.

leuleu stays outside because iterative or continuative reduplication overlaps with TAM/aspect and VP structure.

gengen stays outside because the verbal reduplication evidence is too thin for the first print-facing claim.

kawikawi stays outside because it is expressive, spatial-totality, or lexicalized-looking material.

theithe stays outside because it is report-only and overlaps adverbial, modal, or ability-related territory.

bangbang, *bekbek*, *zenzen*, *tuamtuan*, or similar report-only analysis-table rows stay outside because they are not yet controlled enough for the first slice.

analyzer-noisy, count-only, or theory-heavy whole-system claims stay outside because they do not yet produce a safe first print-facing pattern.

Any broad derivation chapter claim stays outside because this packet is not yet ready to widen one narrow full-reduplication slice into a full derivational account.

Any dictionary-entry claim stays outside because this packet is constructional rather than lexical.

Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest reduplication claim is that Tedim has candidate-controlled evidence for full reduplication used in intensification, with *mahmah* / *mah~mah* as the main anchor and *taktak* / *tak~tak* as the closest support row. Distributive *peuhpeuh* remains visible as secondary evidence, while syntactic, aspectual, verbal, lexicalized-looking, and report-only reduplication rows remain candidate-layer or boundary material.

That claim is deliberately smaller than a full derivation chapter, smaller than a full reduplication chapter, smaller than a TAM/aspect or VP-structure slice, and smaller than a dictionary slice.

Recommended next step

This grammar slice is now paired with `output/publication_review/review_notes_reduplication.md`, so the packet is ready for human review at its current full-reduplication-intensifier slice maturity level.

The next editorial step should be a whole-grammar coverage checkpoint rather than starting another new packet immediately. If more reduplication work is chosen after that checkpoint, the next sub-scope should be distributive *peuhpeuh* or syntactic *ni ni*, not lexicalized-looking or aspect-heavy rows.

Broader discourse

[MAJOR GAP: broader discourse remains partly surfaced and boundary-heavy.]

Current packetized material reaches clause type and sentence-final behavior, but a broader discourse packet is still only partly surfaced and remains boundary-heavy.

Analyzer-gap caution

[MAJOR GAP: analyzer-gap topics remain cross-cutting blockers.]

Analyzer-gap topics still cut across tone in *-a*, conditioned variants, *hong-/kong-*, *-sak*, *-pih*, and related cross-packet boundaries, so they remain visible blockers rather than assembled review prose.

End state of this preview

This assembled review preview contains the actual prose of the current first-pass publication-review grammar slices in a single ordered draft. It does not claim that the whole grammar is finished, and the generated PDF is a review preview PDF rather than a final publication PDF.

References

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